


# BOTANIC *Boutique*

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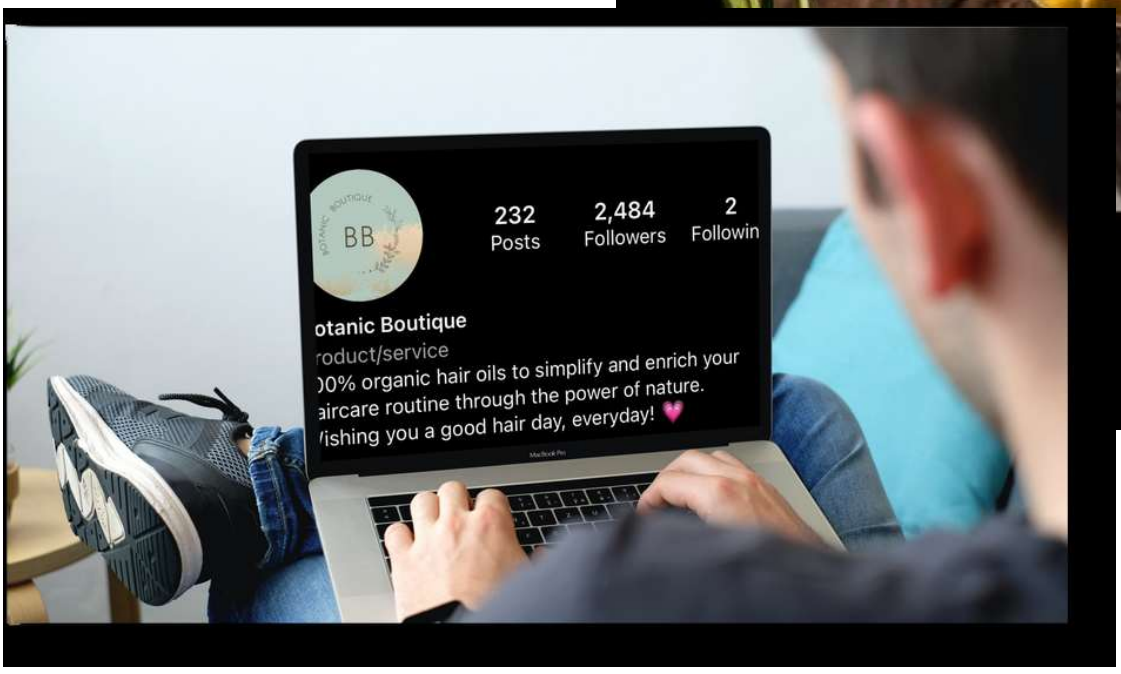
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# HISTORY OF THE BRAND

Botanic Boutique was initiated by two aspiring young ladies- Neha Saleem who works part-time at a Marketing firm and Areej Irfan who is currently a student. They had been preparing the oils and elixirs for some time for their family and friends but were not serving commercially. It was the COVID-19 lockdown period that gave them time to work on their own brand and they decided to channel their energies to introduce and extend their products under the name of "Botanic Boutique" commercially to people who are concerned about their Hair and Skin care. They have had an exciting journey with their products being able to meet the liking criteria of the customer.
They wish and work to take the brand forward and make it a bigger and better name in the industry.



# ABOUT THE BRAND

Botanic Boutique is a brand that understands that there is no One-Size-Fits-All when it comes to Skin and Hair Care and that the world is a busy place where everyone is running short on time. They founded the brand as a labor of love from them to everyone who is seeking a little TLC.




Their specially formulated hair oils and eyelash oil are already blended oils for beauty routine on the go. Whereas their essential oils help the users take charge of their own beauty routine, blending and mixing the exact elixir for their skins.

They believe that apart from being effective, skin and hair care has to be affordable, cruelty-free and transparent. So they serve their customer in a with a range of organic products at affordable prices

## SUPPLY-CHAIN

Both Neha and Areej, the founders, ha ch is one of their strengths. They do import d, as mentioned later in the report. By having most of the items on hand, they have assured that there are no significant delays in their supply chain. They also have multiple suppliers, which means they aren't reliant on any one, giving them additional negotiating power with suppliers. However, recent political events have caused them some difficulties, as their costs have risen as a result of exchange rate fluctuations and import limitations but since quality is more important in skin and hair care products as founded through our insights so they can increase their prices to incorporate for such losses.

# PROJECT INTODUCTION




In the recent years, there is a trend of organic and natural skin and hair care products. People have started talking about whether to use skin products that contain artificial ingredients that might be harmful for the skin in long term for example parabens, sulfates, formaldehydes and many more (healthyoptions.com). This debate gave room for a lot of new brands to emerge with the slogan of providing organic and natural skincare and haircare products which are totally free from artificial ingredients. The products of these brands are priced higher than the other options available in the market which have artificial ingredients.

With the increasing trend of online shopping, a lot of new brands are emerging who sell their products online. Most of these brands start operating from platforms like instagram and facebook because it gives a great start for new emerging brands. The reason behind this is the user base of these platforms and the time that the users spend.

According to the statista.com and backlinko.com, there are more than 1 billion active monthly users of Instagram and 500 million daily active users across the globe. This is a huge number and the majority of the users are youngsters. As per statista, around 80% of the users are from Gen Y and Gen Z. Another reason of starting from Instagram and Facebook is the ease of launching a shop. Instagram has launched a feature of 'Insta Shop' by which anyone can sell the products online through Instagram directly. There is no need to invest huge amounts to develop the websites. Therefore, a lot of new brands are emerging. Our project is around the brand called Botanic Boutique which was also launched on Instagram and Facebook.

Only in Pakistan, there are hundreds of such brands that are selling natural and organic skin and hair care products. Therefore, it becomes very difficult for brands to make a strong customer base which is essentially needed to expand and scale the brand. Therefore, in the light of consumer behavior, we need to look into the various options that can help such brands to create a unique brand identity.

# SCOPE OF THE PROJECT

As internet access and availability grow rapidly around the world, the number of digital buyers keeps climbing year by year. In 2020, over two billion people purchased goods or services online (Statista),

With a 45 percent increase in 2021, the Pakistani eCommerce market contributed to the global growth rate of 29 percent, and e-commerce revenues continue to rise. New markets are emerging, and existing markets have the potential for expansion. (ecommercebd)




social media networks worldwide for e-commerce sales.

As millions of people stayed at home to prevent the spread of the virus in early 2020, digital channels became the most popular alternative to crowded stores and in-person shopping, and this is where Botanic Boutique seized the opportunity. They entered the market full of competitors and substitutes. Competitors include of Hira Ali Beauty, and Conatural, while substitutes range from all hair mask and oil companies, and even normal oils you buy from the stores. Initially, all these competitors were reshaping Botanic Boutiques business strategies in an online marketplace but now that things have begun to normalize, there has been a slight decrease in sales and new customer acquisition has become a challenge for Botanic Boutique. This can mainly be due to the nature of the product. Hair and skin care products are not goods you buy frequently, moreover, they are tested and tried and then recommended to others hence we can say that long maturity can pose to be a threat for Botanic Boutique's new customer acquisition.

Moreover competitors also have websites that help in attracting more customers and enhancing credibility for the business, while Botanic Boutique currently does not have their website. However, talking to Neha and Areej, the owners of the startup, they told us that they will be opening their website soon as well.
Botanic Boutique, which aims to capitalize on these opportunities created by the digital marketplace, plans to expand in the near future. The company primarily focuses on establishing consumer trust and experience by offering high customer-delivered value through multiple channels across the customer journey. The brand should consider various innovative digital marketing strategies to raise awareness and expand its reach. This can assist them in developing a distinct brand identity, thereby creating a unique position of their brand in the minds of the consumers.
The scope of our research will mainly be centered around analyzing and assessing the influence of social media marketing for Botanic Boutique's outlook on buyer preferences and consumer behavior for effective brand promotion, and brand positioning. Hence, this primarily brings our question down to:

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## RESEARCH QUESTION

**"How does Botanic Boutique create differences between its own brand identity and customer perception of competitors through digital marketing strategies?"**




he starting point of our research will be look and analyze Botanic Boutique's onsumer behavior and buying patterns a its social media platforms that are urrently Instagram and Facebook. This ill entail us looking at the brands ngagement across its social media atforms, this comprises of their likes, omments, shares, direct messages alongside customer reviews and collaborations. Instagram and Facebook analytics, such as posts with highest reach will be identified and reasons behind this popularity will be identified.  Throughout their startup journey, Botanic Boutique has reached out to various influencers, such as Sauleha Imtiaz, and Mahnoor Arshad. They have also encouraged consumers to send in their pictures and reviews to improve brand inclusivity. Hence we will analyze all of this and its impact on the profitability and competitiveness of Botanic Boutique.




Furthermore, in our research, we will also carry out a competitor analyses to compare and contrast their marketing and customer journey strategies alongside Botanic Boutique. Customers will include of both prominent and established brands and even other substitutes such as homemade ‘sarsoon ka teel’. To get a holistic approach, we will be using focus groups of our target market and distribute surveys and questionnaires.

We will make sure the questionnaires are open ended so we get qualitative data as to why people are choosing a certain brand over another, and we can fully understand their emotions and reasoning behind their decision.

Our research will be centered around how Botanic Boutique has created a brand identity for itself based on its unique selling point of low prices and fully organic products and how digital marketing has impacted their sales. Moreover we will also be looking at competitors and their social media strategies. By the end of our research, we will provide recommendations to Botanic Boutique about how to further improve customer experience and increase their new customer acquisition rate.

# INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

## Shift in Hair and Skin Care Industry Post COVID-19




Covid-19 has drastically impacted all businesses across the globe while significantly improving the e-commerce and online mode of selling and buying. With this shift in the trend and market, the brands that operate online have become the go-to brands for the customers seeking any product that they never bought online before. Skin and Haircare is one such segment where people usually preferred buying these products from physical stores through seeing, trying samples, or smelling the product pre-COVID. Post-COVID people have tried multiple brands for every product from necessity to luxury. Many trends show people splurging on different online brands during COVID just because they were bored and shopped, and had more disposable incomes to spend on different products. This made them try new brands and an opportunity for founders of Botanic Boutique to sell their care products to people looking for skin and haircare alternatives to what they had been using before. This rise in online buying led to many other competitors entering the market due to extremely low barriers so there is a lot of ongoing competition for Botanic Boutique which made marketing the product right way and satisfying customers' needs extremely important for them to set themselves apart. The customers also make sure to compare the products while buying online because of so many brands offering similar products in this case the customer will always purchase from the brand that provides the best value of money to the customer. If the brand fails to provide a quality product, they will unfortunately not be able to retain the customer and nor will the customer recommend the brand to another person. So, for brands like Botanic Boutique, it is essentially important to provide quality products as word of mouth plays an extremely important role in making them a trusted online brand amidst all the competition.

## Botanic Boutiques Unique Selling Point and Differentiation from Competitors

The virtual retail skin and hair care industry is very competitive; you have multiple similar products being offered, due to the relatively low barriers to entry, making the threat of new entrants high according to **Porter's Five Force Model.** The threat of substitutes products is also high, for example, if people wish to improve their hair they will not only look at hair oil companies, they will also investigate other means such as serums, masks, etc. Likewise, it is a growing market as nowadays people are becoming more concerned with hair and skin care. Moreover, skin and hair care are products you don't experiment with; it's difficult taking risks with such products hence people don't buy them very easily. They look at reviews and also take into account word-of-mouth experiences, especially from friends and family. Thus we can say that Botanic Boutique is facing competition as its difficult to convince and acquire new customers to try the product. It has found success in its product quality, product diversity and customer loyalty.




Botanic Boutique differentiates itself by having excellent product quality. They import most of their raw materials for example they import the tea tree oil from Australia, and their eyelash wands come directly from Dubai. All this is done to ensure that customers get the best product of consistent quality. The brand also has an effective delivery system and delivers products in perfect condition. Their packaging and bottles are made in a way that they remain intact even during nationwide delivery. Due to excellent product quality and an effective delivery system the customers who buy the first time from BB, do make repeat purchases. Likewise, BB has a wide product portfolio- this ranges from a wide variety of four hair oils, six essential face skin products, and an eyelash oil. This differentiation of products leads to a product available for everyone, hence enhancing their popularity.

Another differentiating factor for BB is the fact that their products are 100% organic; unlike other skin and hair companies, they do not add any artificial ingredients and preservatives in their product.

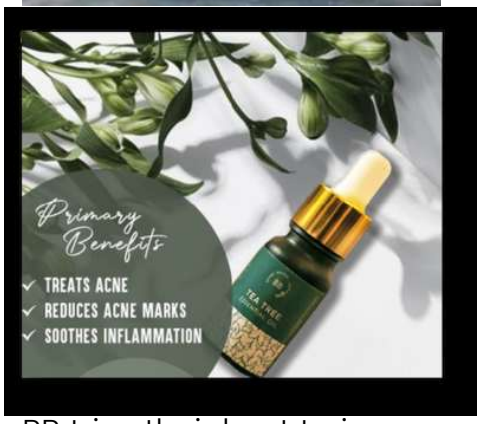
# Micro Economic Factors influencing Botanic Boutique




## Suppliers

Suppliers impact the overall profitability of any business, however having good supplier relationships is extremely important for BB since they import most of their raw materials. They have one main supplier for all their raw materials, but they also keep backup suppliers in case of emergencies. The owners of BB told us how they remain in constant contact with suppliers regarding raw materials and packaging materials and make sure the quality remains intact. They gave us an example of how initially their eyelash oil bottles used to leak and the oil used to drip, thus they asked their suppliers to modify the shape of the bottle and incorporate mascara-type wands in the bottle so the oil application becomes easier.

## Products:




Skin and Haircare products are of long-term nature, meaning, you don't buy them every day, or weekly. Instead, they are bought once the product is finished, which may take up to 3-4 months, depending on the usage. Likewise, you don't necessarily change your skincare and hair care products if you are satisfied with them. Most people change them if they think a certain product isn't suiting them anymore, thus leading to the acquisition of new customers difficult for BB.

BB tries their best to improve product quality. They use the best raw materials and imports them even though that increases their cost, however their main goal is to provide excellent quality organic product to customers.

## Customers

When we asked the owners of BB what an average profile of their customer is, they told us it's of a 20-26 year old working woman who is very busy with her daily routine hence does not have time for proper hair or skincare, thus she can rely on Botanic Boutique for quick and easy solution for all her hair and skin needs. However they did tell us that they don't constrict their target market to only young working women, their products also suit the needs of older women and even men. Currently, BB has problems with acquiring new customers as mentioned above. People who do try the product once, do end up buying it again (repeat purchases) however, the main issue arises in convincing the consumer to try the product at least once.

## Competitors

Botanic Boutique is a part of the industry segment in which there are well-established and huge players that include both direct and indirect competitors for their products. These brands range from high-end brands like Organic to low-end brands like local oil bottles. Post-COVID the market has seen huge growth and a change in trend; from people only trusting 2-3 well-known brands to people trying out newer ones. Botanic Boutique targets the consumer market that needs an on-the-go hair and skincare due to their busy routines, it targets all the ladies looking out for solutions to their hair and skincare without them having to do a lot of work and maintenance, it targets women of all ages primarily but its existence on Instagram only makes it only able to target the younger women from the age of 12-30 and it targets women who are looking for new organic products and trying them out. Given this, their direct competitors include all the hair and skincare brands that are selling online and have a presence on Instagram mainly which include; Hira Ali Beauty, Spa in Bottle, Co-Naturals, and Bk Hair oils. Whereas their in-direct competitors include the brands that are well established and have retail as well as online presences and are trusted brands by customers; Neutrogena, Dove/Pantene/other shampoo brands and desi local oils.

### *Hira Ali Beauty:*




Hira Ali beauty is one of Pakistan's most prominent hair and skincare brands with 81.8K followers. It deals with products ranging from hair oils to different types of skin serums. Their products contain hyaluronic acid which is very good for skin and makes it glowy and hydrated. Most of the sales are of their miracle mask and essential oils that are used in the daily skincare routine. Their price ranges from 500-3000, which falls under the category of affordable products.

### *Co-Natural:*




Co-natural is a health and beauty brand that deals with all kinds of hair care oils made purely of herbal products. Their oils are a go-to solution for people facing hair fall and damaged or dry hair. The natural oils are available at affordable rates that are of good quality and are used in daily routine which falls under the category of affordable products.

## BK Hair Oil:

BK care is a beauty brand made by Bisma khan, a young entrepreneur, who has hair and skincare products. BK care is quite well known among young people and is of very good quality. The marketing by BK care is well known and effective so it is one of the fastest-growing hair and skincare brands having 67.6K followers, available at affordable rates. Spa in Bottle an even stronger competitor of theirs.




## Spa in a Bottle:




Spa in Bottle is one of the direct competitors for Botanic Boutique as the nature of the products that is sells and its target audience is the same as that of Botanic Boutique. Their way of packaging is also quite similar to Botanic Boutique. They now have a following of 99.7K. They are also continuously expanding their product range and are coming up with new treatments for skin and hair which are different from what others offer. Their elixirs and mixtures are quite effective and naturally extracted. They are now selling through Al-fatah stores in addition to their online presence, which has given them an increased market segment to target. As Botanic Boutique is planning to place their product in Al-fatah as well this makes Spa in Bottle an even stronger competitor of them.

## Shampoos such as Dove, Loreal etc.:

The products offered by the big and already established brands like Dove, Loreal, Nivea, Garnier, etc. are also the competitors of botanic boutique because they offer the substitutes of hair & skin care products. Products of these brands are easily available in almost all the markets and they have been operating for decades. This heavily influences the buying behavior because consumers perceive that these products are already tested and have better effects.



## Other Home Substitutes:



Various substitutes are available in homes for the products that are offered by Botanic boutique like mustard oil (sarso). This has been used by our elders and it is vastly known for its healthier impacts on hair. This is also 100% organic and cheap as well as compared to other branded natural oils which are expensive. Therefore, this can be counted as a direct competitor as well.



# RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The study's main goal would be to examine Botanic Boutique's consumer behavior and purchasing trends through its digital presence. To do so, we'll perform both primary and secondary research to delve further into the subject and learn more about it. It's crucial to analyse both qualitative and quantitative data, which is why our mixed-method methodology may help us integrate perspectives and build a more complete picture




## SAMPLING

Botanic Boutique is a brand that caters to the needs of those who are concerned about their skin and hair care problems however do not have the time to invest in these issues, thus our sample will target females and males both who are working individuals, and want products that are suitable for their skin type. The main behavioural segmentation aspect we will cater to is easy to use, alongside convenience. Likewise, since BBs price point is much lower compared to competitors, we will target mainly the middle and upper middle class people.

To get more information and ins
participating in the focus group
important hair and skincare pro
essential for people belonging to all age groups, so the target audience would be people ranging from age 18-50

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# PRIMARY RESEARCH

## 1. OBSERVATION & SOCIAL LISTENING

An essential qualitative research technique will be observation, in which we will covertly monitor the ongoing behavior of BB and their competitor's customers in a natural setting. The goal of this type of study is to obtain more reliable information through the participant's interaction with the brand's social media pages. In other words, we can collect data on what individuals actually do rather than what they claim to do. This will help us form informed perceptions about customers and thereby make business decisions accordingly. A part of the observation technique will be social listening in which we will observe the consumer behavior around a brand. We'll monitor the brand's social media channels on a regular basis for customer feedback and direct mentions of the brand, as well as discussions about certain keywords, themes, competitors, and then conduct an analysis to obtain insights. We'll use a zero-interaction technique, in which the people being observed will have no knowledge about the study and its goals hence increasing fewer chances of bias. Our observational research will be split into the following parts

→ We will conduct a competitor brand observation strategy in which we will travel to stores such as Alfatah and Jalal Sons and silently study competitor brand buying patterns as well as how consumers interact and talk about them. How convinced are they when making a decision? What kind of discussions are they having? Are they accompanied by friends or are they alone? What is it that attracts them the most? Our group will collect and analyse all of this qualitative information.

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→ An experimental observation method will be used where a group of participants would be introduced to the Instagram and Facebook pages of hair and skincare brand, BB. The participants will thereafter be permitted to buy and browse whatever they want without being interacted with. We'll try to figure out what they're looking for and buying. What items/posts are drawing the most customers? How long the consumer spends on each post and which one he or she spends the most time on. What does he or she purchase? All of this qualitative data will be analysed further to uncover insights. Twenty men and women who use social media platforms, ranging in age of 18-50, will be included in the sample.

Two members of the group will focus on social listening, with the primary focus being on the brand's reviews. They will observe the comments under each post and any discussion of competitor brands across all of the digital channels.

### LIMITATIONS

Despite being the simplest method, the social desirability bias might cause results to be skewed. If the participant realises he or she is being watched, he or she may alter their behavior. This is known as the Hawthorne effect. Aside from that, ethical considerations could be a problem because we won't be able to observe everything in detail, resulting in less clarity in the outcomes. Finally, there may be issues about lack of accuracy because the results may be difficult to interpret due to confirmation and personal bias on the part of our group's observer.



## 2. FOCUS GROUP

Secondly, we will be conducting focus groups which are one of the most effectively used research methodologies and will give us more insight into our consumer behaviour. This group interaction will assist us in providing qualitative data that is rich in detail. It will provide a forum in which the moderator will aid participants to engage in discussion, flushing out their opinions on the brand's perception, products, and customer experience. The discussion will continue to seek insights into customer behaviour, their decision-making processes, and attitudes. It will outline the buying habits of customers, their preferences, and what they look for when they have a hair or skin problem. We will try to figure out what issues' customers are having and what they think of Botanic Boutique, as well as competitive brands and replacements such as mustard oil.




We will hold three focus groups on Zoom, each with 7-8 participants with one being scheduled already for the week after next. Moderators will encourage the participants to turn on their videos. This would allow us to observe the audience's body language, facial expressions, gestures, and movement while responding to queries. These specifics are equally important because they can help us affirm our findings. Two focus groups will have a homogeneous audience, while the third one will have a heterogeneous audience. The groups will be representative of our entire sample (target place and audience). We will have a varied audience so that we can see and collect relevant data from a variety of perspectives. They will include Botanic Botique's current customers, potential customers, competitor customers, and substitute users. It will be our top priority to minimise any bias from our discussion. We will make sure that the environment in the group is friendly and inviting, allowing people to freely express their concerns. Also, moderators will persuade the audience to write their answers on a sheet and then show them collectively at once.

This reduces any group and social desirability bias. Moreover, the group will help us learn more about consumers' expectations and perceptions of an online hair and skincare brand through focus groups and further obtain additional information about the factors that increase the likelihood of consumer purchases on a social media platform. The questions can be about hair and skincare in general, such as what kinds of problems you regularly face. What kind of advertisements do you like that grab your attention? These questions will then move on to the brand specifically.

## LIMITATIONS

This could contain a variety of prejudices. The first one is groupthink bias, in which the participants modify their opinions and listen to what the rest of the group is saying. Similarly, many argue that groups suffer from bounded awareness; meaning, instead of sharing new and unique information, groups tend to produce shared information-information that was previously known to other group members. Apart from that, there may be personal bias on the part of the moderator, which could lead to mistakes in the results, therefore they should be made aware of this and urged to remain neutral and not express any emotions during the debate. Finally, the sample size can be a limiting factor. Because the sample size is so small, the results may not be accurate or representative.

# 3. INTERVIEWS

We will be interviewing both the founders and the consumers to have a deep understanding of Botanic boutique. Interviews of the co-founders will help us to understand what they want their brand to be in the future. How they are currently serving their customers and what insights do they have about their consumers. Interviews of consumers will help us to understand what the consumers want in the hair and skincare products. What are their wants and what do they expect from brands that offer such products? Also, the brand that we are studying is in the hair and skincare industry. The effects of using such products cannot be seen readily, rather it takes time. Sometimes, even the consumer itself doesn't know what remedies helped to get the results because this is a very complex thing. Therefore, conducting only surveys and focus groups wouldn't be enough to study the consumers. Rather, we will have to interview them to deeply understand the consumer needs, wants, and expectations of such products.

## Limitations:

Conducting enough interviews will be difficult because of time constraints. We will have to schedule interviews with the founders, consumers. Finding the suitable times that fit in schedules will be difficult. Therefore, we think we will not be able to conduct much interviews. However, we will still try to conduct at least 3-5 interviews of consumers.



# 4. SURVEYS

We would be using surveys to gather customer insights along with other research methods. This research method is important for our research because we will be able to not only get customer insights but we can easily get insights from people who are neither the target market of the product right now nor have they heard about the product nor have they purchased the product yet. This would help us gather insights on potential customers as to who else could be the target market for the products that the founders have not been considering before and what are the strategies that we can use to target them to ensure the brand reaches them as well. Moreover, structuring the survey in a way that is neutral and asks more for marketing recommendations in strategically designed questions would be an asset for us as the best marketing strategies come from the core of customers.

This method however has its own set of limitations like all other methods, the most common being unauthentic responses by people in surveys just to save time, or giving biased answers because of the brand logos, etc.
Secondly, the findings of this research method can not be generalized to a larger population nor can causality be inferred from it. Only a correlation can be established from the findings but most of the time finding causality is extremely important.

Moreover, some questions are qualitative in nature, and compiling them would be hard In the case where they are given certain numbers 1-7 or strongly agree or disagree they may lose information as there are no set standards for them, and they are left or people's evaluation of how strong is 7 and how weak is 1.

We would be conducting these surveys through in person visits to retail stores, door to door visit or going to public places. The idea is to make sure we can also capture some emotions and body ques along with the survey as well as to make sure people are actually filling them. We will also be sending them out to people over whatsApp to increase reachability, but we will make sure to include questions in between that will check if people are actually reading and filling or just randomly clicking and discard the surveys which do not affirm to this, thus maintaining the quality of the research.

# SECONDARY RESEARCH

As mentioned above, in current times, there is a huge shift towards online brands. Especially Covid-19 lockdowns highly boosted the e-commerce industry. A lot of new brands emerged during COVID and the already established well-known brands also made sure their online presence or tried to expand it if they were already doing that earlier. Therefore, each bran has to be creative in differentiating itself from competitors in order to establish its identity and attract new customers. Hence, conducting secondary research is also necessary to get better insights into your competitors, consumers, etc.

Along with primary research, secondary research als plays a vital role while conducting marketing researc It not only gives a broader understanding of the scop of research but also helps to confirm the results that you deduce from your primary research. We will do secondary research in order to see what Botanic Boutique can do in order to differentiate itself from competitors and increase its consumer base. We will be using the following secondary research methods:




## Literature Review

We will be reviewing the already available research in which similar problems were identified or solved. It wi give us deep insights of what strategies were used by the already present online brands in order to broaden base. It will help us to understand our brand in a bett perspectives. We will try to find out how the social me brand identity in the e-commerce industry.

### Competitors:

We will study the social media pages of the competitors of Botanic Boutique and try to analyze their marketing strategies. We will try to understand how these competitors are engaging with their customers in an online environment and what kind of content they are posting. It will help us to devise a better strategy for Botanic Boutique.

## COMPANY'S OWN FINANCIAL DATA AND SOCIAL MEDIA INSIGHTS:

We will also use the financial data of Botanic boutique like sales data, repeat customers ratios and conversion rates, etc. in our research to get better consumer insights. We will also analyze their social media insights like gender ratio, peak engagement times and locations, etc. Both things combined can help us to better understand the consumers of the brand.



# RESEARCH QUESTION

**How does Botanic Boutique create differences between its own brand identity and customer perception of competitors through digital marketing strategies?**

## SUBQUESTIONS: COMPONENTS OF THE RESEARCH QUESTION

### How important is new customer acquisition for startups like Botanic Boutique?

The products like Botanic boutique need to focus more on their research target market to stay ahead of their competitors and create differentiation. To understand the customer's behavior behind buying something, BB needs to collect the company sales data and conduct market research through using primary research methods like focus groups, surveys, and interviews to learn their behavior and to improve their product according to the customer's wants.

### Are lower prices an issue for Botanic Boutique in terms of customer perception?

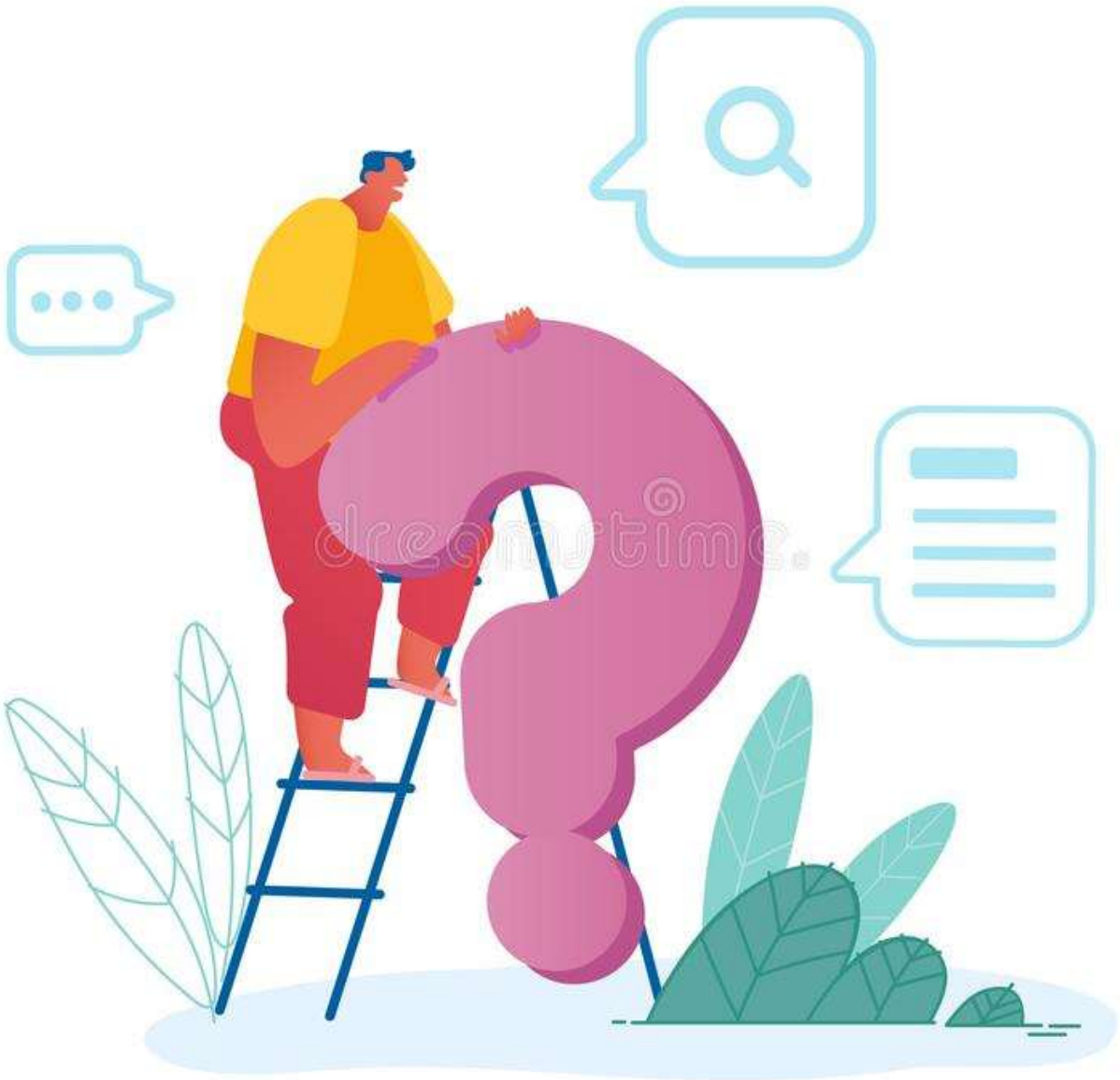
It's a common perception that if something is available at a low price then it wouldn't be of very good quality, but this fact is not true for all products. To get a deep understanding of it and if it is an issue for Botanic Boutique, we shall understand the logic and view of our target market. For this purpose, our team will be collecting the pricing data from the company. Moreover, as far as primary research is concerned, we will be conducting focus groups to get a clear and detailed understanding of the purchase decisions of a consumer for instance what goes in the mind of people when they get to know the price.

### Can expansion into physical retail stores increase customer satisfaction and enhance new customer acquisition?

The majority of the customers prefer buying products at physical stores, which allows them to examine the products and clear their concerns regarding their purchases. However, after the outbreak of Covid-19, consumer behavior shifted towards online shopping and e-commerce which was a short-term occurrence. To understand whether the expansion into physical stores can increase customer satisfaction and enhance new customer acquisition, we will take a mixed-method strategy. First of all, Analysis of our secondary research will help us understand the market trends and the behavior of people regarding shopping and their preferences while primary research will give us the qualitative data around what our target market thinks and what they prefer.

**Do the benefits of using social media influencers outweigh the costs ?**

In the world of social media, where it is the most effective way of reaching out to customers, using social media influencers to market your product is very common and beneficial. To get a better idea of it, we will do secondary research which will allow us to calculate the total costs of marketing and ROI. It will be important to calculate the cost of sales, technical, advertising and creative costs etc. This will lead us to total customer acquisition costs. Furthermore, analyzing Instagram data and insights will give a better picture. In primary research, conducting focus groups can help us gain insights of consumer behavior by asking questions like what role social media influencers play in their purchase decision?



# SWOT Analysis

01

## STRENGTHS

- **Long term nature of the product:**

Most consumers do not tend to switch between their hair and skin products; if they are satisfied with a product, they will continue using it hence most of BB's customers continue using the product thus leading to high customer loyalty

- **Price point and customer loyalty:**

BB's price point is lower compared to competitors, while their product quality is high. Moreover, their products are fully organic hence their customers are loyal to them. Even when looking at statistics, we see that the percentage of repeat purchases is high as 70% (according to stats provided by Botanic Boutique)

- **Organic:**

BB sells fully natural products; they don't add any artificial materials. Nowadays society is moving towards buying organic products hence this provides BB with a competitive edge.

- **Eyelash oil Wand:**

BB is the only company in Pakistan that has a mascara type of a wand for its eyelash oil. This is very effective in making sure the oil reaches the tip of the eyelash hence we can say that BB provides superior product quality.

- **Price display:**

BB displays their prices under their posts, thus enhancing convenience for the customer. When we asked in the focus group what consumers look for in a social media page while buying the product, most participants stated how mentioning the price in the description/caption helps enhance customer loyalty and satisfaction.

- **Male skin care products:**

BB has also introduced 'Apollo Hair Oil for Men', which has ingredients based solely for male hair hence we can say that BB attracts both the female and male demographics.

# SWOT Analysis

02

## WEAKNESSES

- **Lack of newly acquired customers:**

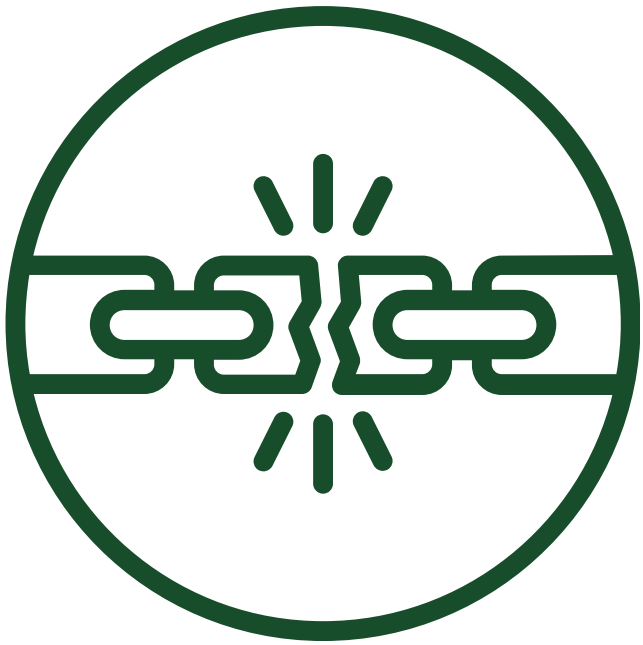
Since BB is a new business, they have problems in new customer acquisition. The number of new customer purchases is very low as very few people know about the brand.

- **Lack of brand awareness:**

Due to the market being dominated by well-known competitors such as Hira Ali Beauty or Co naturals, many hair and skin care customers do not know about BB. Even in the focus group when we asked participants if they have heard about the brand, majority said no.

- **Reliance on external party for delivery:**

BB does not have their own riders; hence it may be difficult for them to keep track of product deliveries. Likewise, outsourcing delivery can sometime adversely affect product quality - the third party may try to deliver as may products as it can. Thus, they may act careless while delivering.



# SWOT Analysis

03

## OPPURTUNITIES

- **Face Masks:**

Face masks are a must when it comes to skincare and those who follow a proper skincare routine never miss this essential part of their routine. What Botanic Boutique can do is expand their products line to face masks as well. Charcoal face masks, mud masks, and Aloe Vera masks are the types of masks that BB can look into and start making so that their customer won't have to look for other options because they'll get the masks, they need, from them.

- **Personalized Products:**

We create a special association with those brands that customize our products or take suggestions and make personalized orders. Since skin and hair care is very personal for the users and sometimes, they don't get the product they want. Botanic Boutique can use this opportunity to create a loyal customer base by giving them the option of telling how they want their product to be while placing the order. This will give Botanic boutique a competitive advantage over its competitors and would also help in expanding the customer base as well.

- **Focus more on male skin/hair care products:**

Botanic Boutique should focus more on male-oriented skin and hair care products because, in this age and time, men are as much concerned about their skin and hair as women. So, Botanic Boutique can use this opportunity to expand the customer base and attract more customers by providing them the products according to their skin types and catering to the problems that they face related to their hair and skin. Moreover, they should also add more reviews of males using their products to influence others to use their products as well.



# SWOT Analysis

04

## THREATS

Botanic Boutique is an online business running through Instagram and Facebook pages. These pages cannot be trusted as much when it comes to a proper business and customers usually don't find them as reliable. What BB should do is to make their official website so that customers would be able to easily place orders and keep a track of their packages, which would make the customer experience better.

- **Competitors:**

Online businesses are flourishing in the last few years in Pakistan and the competition is also increasing in all businesses as well because entering the online businesses is comparatively easier. These competitors are a threat to Botanic Boutique because all of them are selling almost the same product, so it becomes very difficult to stand out and keep growing in this situation. Botanic Boutique should put in continuous efforts to understand the consumer behavior and their changing choices to keep making products according to their demand and to keep their customers satisfied.

- **Economic Situation of the Country:**

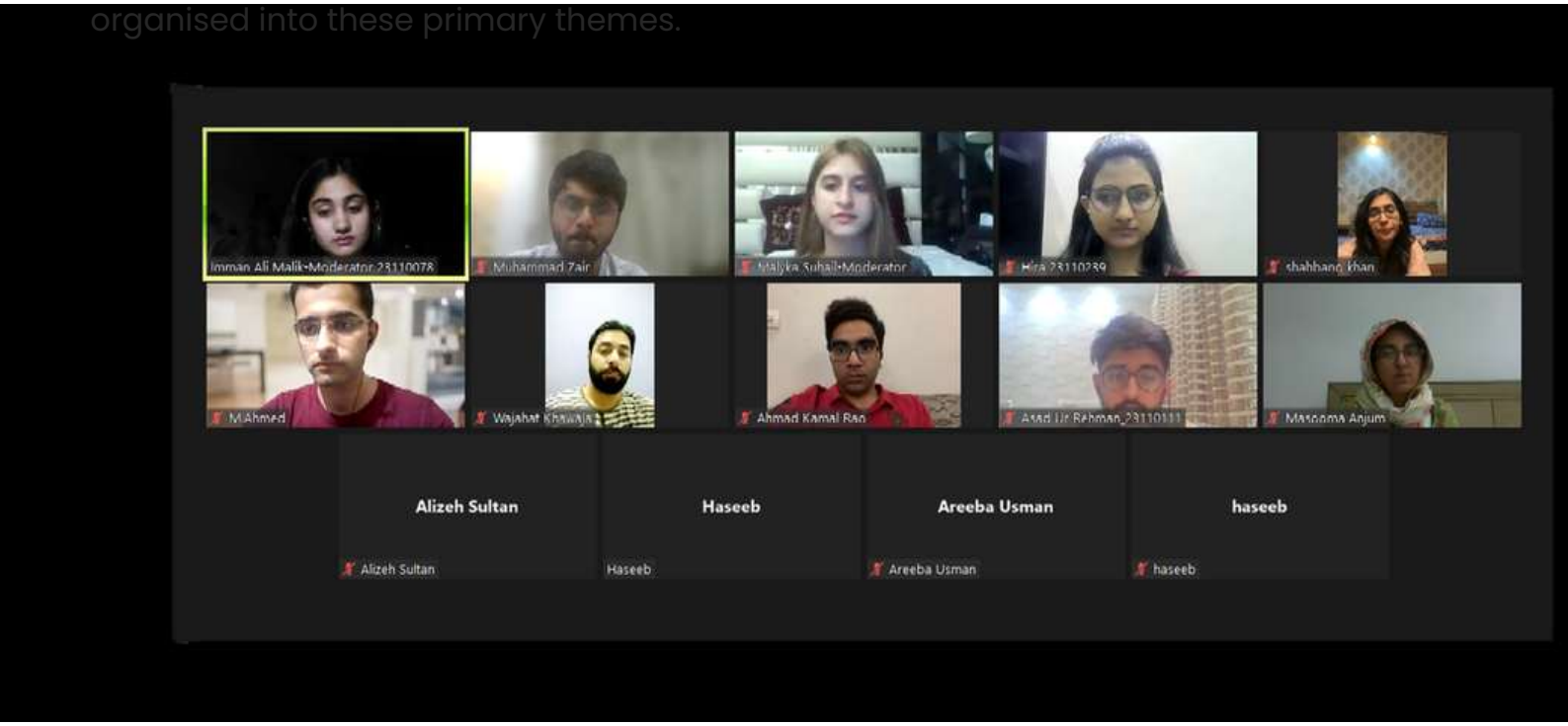
Since, BB relies on international suppliers, currency devaluation and import duties/limitations leads to increase in their costs.




INSIGHTS

# FOCUS GROUP INSIGHTS

We conducted two focus groups, both with homogeneous audiences. First one had respondents who used hair and skin care products from various brands, whether it be Botanic Boutique or any competitor, and are not new to online shopping. The other group included people who were not hair and skin care users but could be potential customers of the company. We were able to gain some extremely useful insights, which we organised into these primary themes.




## • ONLINE VS INSTORE

When we questioned if they were comfortable buying skin and hair care goods online, the majority of respondents in both the focus groups preferred in-store shopping for skin care products due to the increased risk of product quality.

> When it comes to skin care, I prefer visiting to retail stores because these are products that you will apply to your face, therefore I will never take a chance, whereas for hair care, I can buy online too ~ Junaid Ahmed

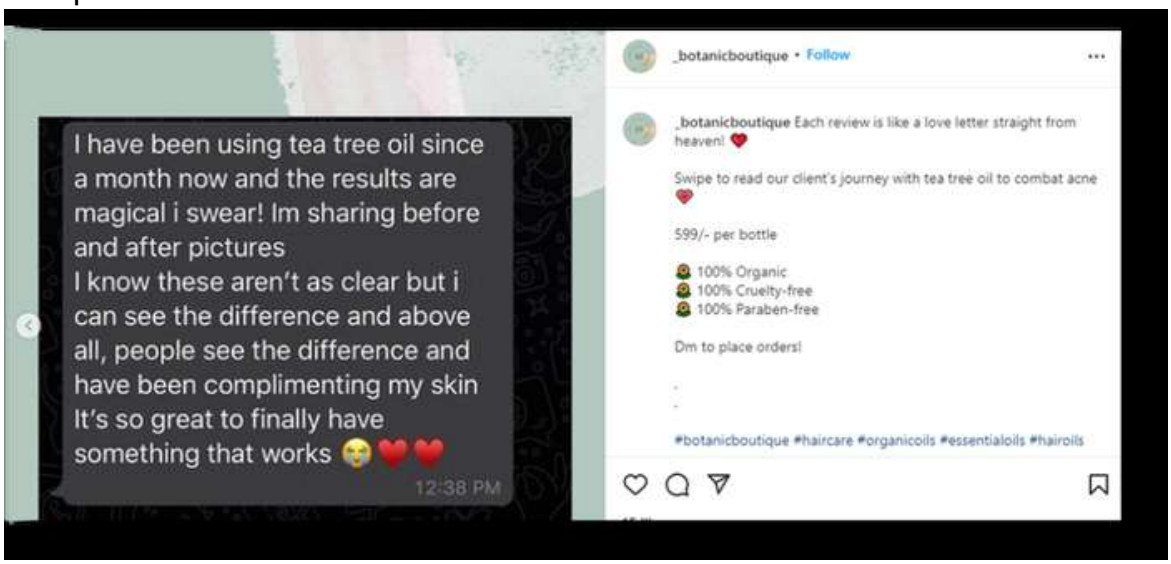
However, due to the closing of retail stores, the COVID-19 pandemic shifted consumer behaviour towards buying online, as customers began to experiment online. More brands went online, giving customers more opportunities to shop from the comfort of their own homes. However, now that the things are returning back to normal, majority of our focus group participants reported that they are returning to in-store experiences. This can result in a big challenge for Botanic Boutique in terms of new customer acquisition.



- **Factors Influencing Consumer Behavior**

**Reviews:**

Botanic Boutique has a separate highlight on Instagram specifically for reviews, likewise, they also frequently post their customer reviews on their page, an example of this can be seen in the picture below

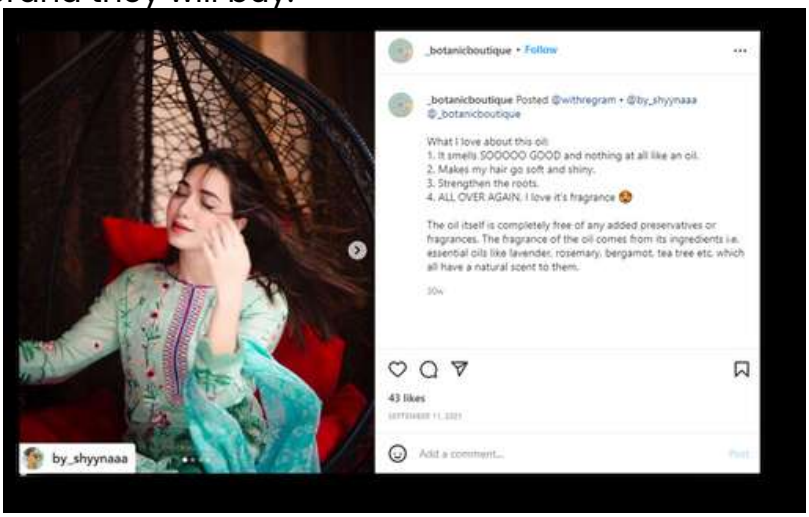



BB continuously keep updating their reviews highlights; this ensures trust and credibility of the brand as the reviews appear genuine, and not fabricated and fake. During the focus group, majority of the participants mentioned how important reviews are in deciding what business to buy from. When we showed them BB's page, the main positive thing everyone mentioned was how they post authentic reviews; these include of both influencers' reviews alongside normal consumers. According to some participants, such as Hassan, aged 22, influencers usually market according to their own benefit, hence reviews by normal customers are a more accurate picture of what the product quality will be like.

However, some focus group participants raised the concern that since the brand is a comparatively new and small-scale startup, maybe these reviews are mostly by friends or family, thus ensuring 100% credibility can be a difficult task for BB.



When we see BB's social media pages, we notice how they have posted reviews and videos by multiple influencers, especially Instagram bloggers. This include of Shaina Gull, 323k followers, Mahnoor A Mahmood, 53.4k followers, Scary Ammi, 29.2k followers and many more. They also send PR to various influencers so they can try the product and post about it; there is also a separate highlight which talks about PRs only. Many focus group participants agreed that social media influencers play a big role in determining which brand they will buy.







However, the majority of the focus group participants believed in social media advertising to be a 'scam' since these influencers are paid to promote the product, hence they may not be completely honest.

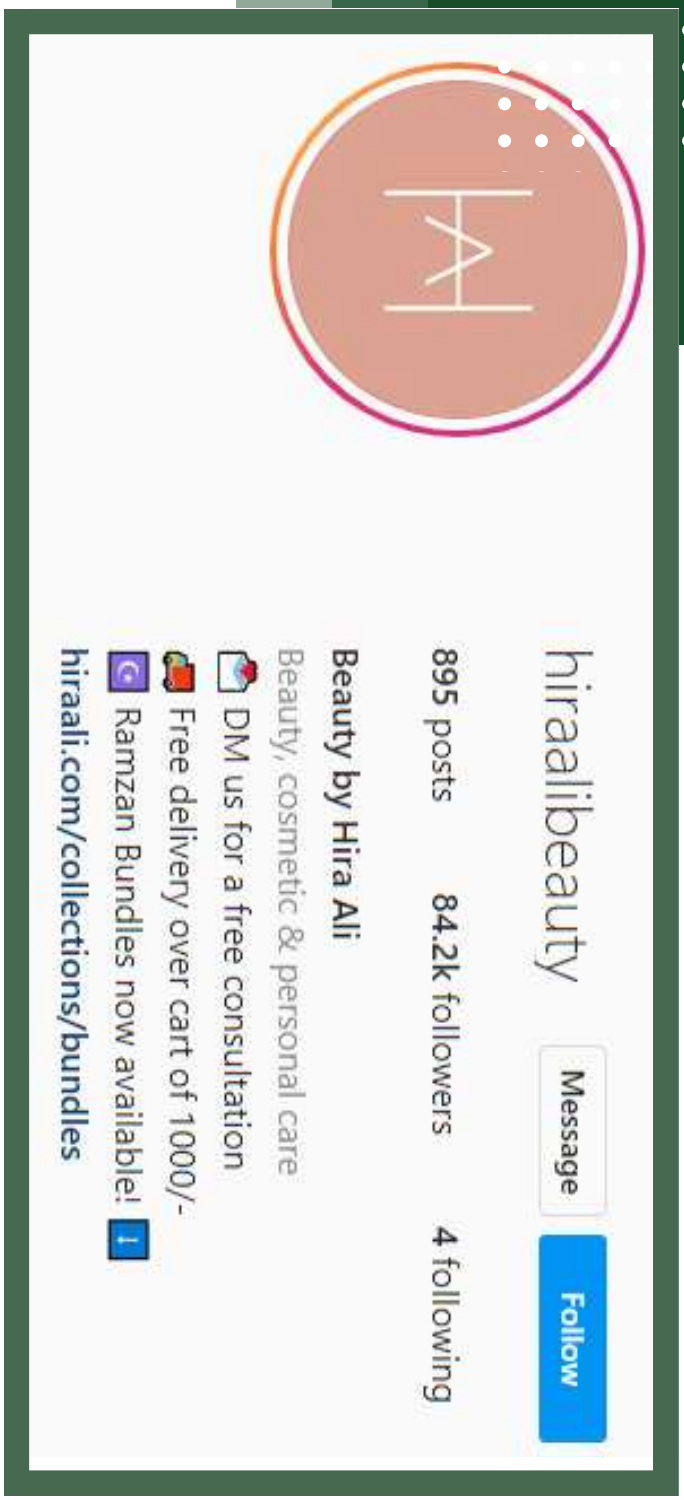
As Hassan mentioned " **I would think about the reason why the influencer is promoting the brand. If I get the idea that promotion is just for personal benefit, I do not prefer it.** "

- **Word of mouth:**

One major theme that kept constantly emerging in the focus group was the importance of word of mouth reviews; in other words, advice and recommendations by friends and family. As Asad mentioned, **'friends and family impact my decision towards buying from a certain brand, alongside the PR of the brand.'** Even Fatima agreed with this and said **'friends and family recommendations matter more than influencers as their experiences are more relevant to us.'** As mentioned above, buying skin and hair products is risky since you will be using it on your face and hair, thus customers tend to buy from brands that are tried and tested by people they trust, hence word of mouth, according to our focus group plays an important aspect when it comes to skin and hair care products.

# • FOLLOWING

From our focus group, we found out that Instagram following of the brand is an important factor when it comes to brand credibility. More followers lead to more trust being created for the brand. We asked our focus group participants to compare the page/followers of both Botanic Boutique and Hira Ali Beauty. Hira Ali Beauty has over 84k followers, while Botanic Boutique currently only has 2482 followers on Instagram. There can be various reasons for this difference, one of them being time. Hira Ali has been in the market since quite a few years now, while BB was launched during 2020 quarantine, hence its relatively newer, thus lacks recognition. When the focus group participants saw the followers of both pages, they immediately linked credibility to number of followers. As mentioned by Junaid, 'One immediate difference is the number of followers. I would prefer this (Hira Ali Beauty) one because of followers.' Likewise, Aimen also said, 'Hira Ali has a lot more following which is reliable and credible.'



## • PAGE AESTHETICS




Botanic Boutique has presence on Instagram only. The participants of both the focus groups and survey were shown the page and asked for their thought, reactions and recommendations for the page.
The insights showed that Botanic Boutique's page is an aesthetic and refreshing one. At the first glance it is able to capture customers attention and customers like the vibe of the page which is a very subtle yet fun and a very natural and organic one. The customer gets a feel of product through the page as the minty color used very frequently in posts creates a cooling effect to the eyes, that also instantly delivers the message of the products being organic. The color palette used by the brand are that from Mexican color palette that give life to the page as well as a fun feel. The logo of the brand is a minimalistic design with a leaves branch added to give life to it and help people establish the identity of brand on the instant that they look at it. The highlights are very minimalistically kept with only four out there but important ones. The overall theme of the page remains coherent throughout the posts and is aesthetic to eyes specially to aesthetes out there. The captions of the posts are informative and also include symbols like sunflowers to make them in line with the theme throughout. However, the page lacks human element, towards the start there are shout outs from influencers but a more refreshing thing to see would be actual customers sending pictures with applied product. The tag line of "Wishing you good hair day, everyday' helps owners of brands to convey their message directly to the customers and speak to them creating a sense of care that they extend to their customers. The tag line however, misses any mentions of skin care thus someone looking at the page would only assume it to be a hair care brand. The following of the page is around 2482 which shows the reach and the customer base of the brand is low and is an important thing that attracts customer attention. It is a negative reflection for potential buyers of the Brand. The feel of the page is premium with nice packaging of products, which also attracts the customer and develop their first contact to the product, helping them visualize it.

## • PRICE & DELIVERY




Most of the respondent's decisions in both the groups weren't greatly influenced by the difference in prices. We showed the participants the price ranges of Botanic Boutique and subsequently the price ranges of the competitors. It's important to note that a Botanic Boutique had prices that were roughly 40% lower than most of its competitors. When we told the participants about this, they were not thrilled. Because skin and hair care products are high involvement products, quality played a more important part than price.

As far as delivery is concerned, all of the participants favored short delivery periods and low delivery costs. If delivery is not guaranteed, respondents state that it is highly likely that they will switch to a different brand.



# PRODUCT VARIETY

Botanic Boutique offers a wide range of products under three major categories: Eyelash oils, Hair oils, and Skincare serums and oils. This gives customers a wide range of options to select the ones that suit them the most according to their skin type and sensitivity. We showed our participants products from these three categories and asked them to share their opinions and views.

- **Eyelash Oil:**

Ravitalash eyelash growth oil is one of their best-selling products that is used for longer, fuller, and thicker eyelashes made purely of organic ingredients. Most participants said they would be willing to buy it considering the quality, packaging and everything is excellent at a very reasonable price. Because most of the Botanic boutique's competitors are selling such products at comparatively higher rates, so Botanic Boutique is ahead of them when it comes to price without compromising on quality.

- **Haircare oils:**

In the hair oils category, Botanic Boutique offers four different kinds of oils, that cater to different hair problems and are made of different ingredients.

- **Parfaire elixir hair oil:**

It is an all-in-one solution for longer, thicker, and silkier hair, available in bottles of 100ml and 200ml. The 100ml bottle is being sold for Rs. 799 only and the 200ml one is sold for Rs. 1399 only. These are quite reasonable prices when it comes to hair oils made up of purely organic ingredients.

- **Rejuvic Hair oil:**

This hair oil is used if you're tired of hair fall problems and want longer and thicker hair. Hair fall is something that we all are worried about, and this hair oil provides the solution for hair fall prevention. The 100ml bottle is available for Rs. 699 and the 200ml one is available for Rs. 1249.



# PRODUCT VARIETY

**Repare hair oil:**

We all are so busy in our daily lives that we do not get time to look after our hair and they get really dry and rough. Botanic Boutique is a brand that is for all, and it tries to provide the solution to all problems. This hair oil is for repairing dry, dull, and rough hair and making them smooth, soft, and silky. The price of this hair oil is also very reasonable, Rs. 699 for a 100ml bottle and Rs. 1249 for a 200ml bottle.

**Apollo Hair Oil for Men:**

Botanic Boutique makes products for both men and women and doesn't forget that men need hair and skincare as much as women. So, this hair oil is for men, it repairs damaged, dull, and dry hair and is made of 100% organic ingredients. The 100ml bottle is available for Rs. 799 and the 200ml one is available for Rs. 1399.

èWe showed these products to our participants, and they like the aesthetics, packaging and especially the prices of the products and most of them were willing to buy them. Most interestingly the prices that they guessed when we showed them the bottles were way higher than the original prices which convinced them that they should at least try these products.

**Skin Care:**

Skincare is very essential for having fresh and healthy skin and Botanic Boutique has a huge range of skincare products for those who are concerned about their skin and don't have much time to spend on it.

**Rosehip oil:**

This oil is especially for treating dark spots, open pores, signs of aging, and heals uneven skin texture, and brightens the dull skin. This serum is available for Rs. 500 in a bottle of 10ml.

**Lavender Oil:**

Their lavender oil is specialized in treating pigmentation, dark spots, signs of aging, acne, eczema, and inflammation and helps in healing clogged pores. This all-in-one skin serum can also be bought for Rs. 500 only in a bottle of 10ml.

# PRODUCT VARIETY

**Lemongrass oil:**
This oil detoxifies the skin, helps in reducing acne scars, fights dandruff, and makes the skin brighter. Moreover, it also makes the skin clear by reducing hair growth on the face. This magic skin essential oil is available for Rs. 450 in a bottle of 10ml.

**Argon oil:**
This special oil treats stretch marks, heals sun damage and inflammation, and removes the oiliness from skin caused because of acne. This Essential skin oil can be bought for Rs. 650 per 10ml.

**Tea tree oil:**
This unique skin oil treats acne, acne marks, itchy skin, eczema, and dandruff, and is best for oily skin types. The oil can be ordered online through their social media pages for Rs. 599 per 10ml.

**Peppermint oil:**
This hair oil is best for dry skin types and is best in treating dull skin, acne inflammation, dandruff, and prevents hair loss. The oil can be bought for Rs. 550 in a bottle of 10ml.

We showed our participants these skincare products and they were quite impressed with the quality, packaging, and the fact that almost all their problems were being addressed and the solution was provided for them. So, they were more than willing to test these products.



BOTANIC BOUTIQUE

BB

# EYELASH Oil







## REVITALASH EYELASH GROWTH OIL

FOR LONGER, FULLER & THIKER EYELASHES

**RS 399**

BOTANIC BOUTIQUE

BB

# HAIR Oils




## PARFAIRE ELIXIR HAIR OIL

AN ALL-IN-ONE SOLUTION FOR LONGER & SILKIER HAIR

100ML- RS 799
200ML- RS 1399




## REJUVIC HAIR OIL

FOR LONGER HAIR & HAIR FALL PREVENTION

100ML- RS 699
200ML- RS 1249

## RÉPARE HAIR OIL

FOR REPAIRING DRY, DULL & ROUGH HAIR

100ML- RS 699
200ML- RS 1249







## APOLLO HAIR OIL FOR MEN

FOR MOISTURIZING AND REPAIRING DRY OR DAMAGED HAIR.

100ML- RS 799
200ML- RS 1399

# ESSENTIAL Oils

BOTANIC BOUTIQUE

BB



## ARGON OIL

TREATS STRETCH MARKS, SUN DAMAGE, INFLAMMATION, SKIN OILINESS, ACNE

**10ML- RS 650**



## TEA TREE OIL

TREATS ACNE, ACNE MARKS, OILY SKIN, ITCHY SKIN, ECZEMA, DANDRUFF

**10ML- RS 599**



## PEPPERMINT OIL

TREATS DRY SKIN, DULL SKIN, ACNE INFLAMMATION DANDRUFF, HAIR LOSS.

**10ML- 550**



## ROSEHIP OIL

TREATS DARK SPOTS, OPEN PORES, SIGNS OF AGING, UNEVEN SKIN TEXTURE AND DULL SKIN

**10ML- RS 500**



## LAVENDER OIL

TREATS PIGMENTATION, DARK SPOTS, SIGNS OF AGING, ACNE, ECZEMA, INFLAMMATION, CLOGGED PORES

**10ML- RS 500**



## LEMONGRASS OIL

FOR DETOXIFYING SKIN, REDUCING ACNE SCARS, FIGHTING DANDRUFF AND PROMOTING HAIR GROWTH

**10ML- 450**

# ESSENTIAL *Oils*

BOTANIC BOUTIQUE

BB

## • PACKAGING

One very important and significant insight we got from our focus group was that packaging plays a very important role when it comes to buying things online. It impacts the overall consumer experience and their buying journey because they feel like aesthetics, boxes, and colors play a huge role in influencing their decision to buy products.

**"For me, if I don't like the packaging and it's not according to my expectations like if it doesn't satisfy me, I won't even buy that product." - Shahbano**

Botanic Boutique pays special attention to it, and they have a very delicate and attractive packaging that captures the attention of the customers. Moreover, since they have to deliver products all over the country their boxes are also strong to make sure that the bottles that are inside the box don't get damaged.

## • Modes of Payment:

The mode of payment is very crucial when it comes to online businesses. Many people said that they prefer band transfers because it saves them the hassle of dealing with cash and they can easily purchase things online. While some said that they prefer cash on delivery because it gives them the satisfaction of paying after receiving their parcel in a good state. Botanic Boutique offers both, but it varies from city to city. They accept cash on delivery in Lahore, Islamabad, Karachi, and Rawalpindi while in other cities they accept jazz cash and bank transfers. So, they try their best to accommodate the customers and to make their experience with Botanic Boutique free of any hassle.



# • COMPETITORS

When we asked the participants of the focus group of the brands that come to their mind when they hear the words skin and hair care, there was a wide range of brands and products that they named from Nivea to loreal to organic to ordinary, from local oils to parachute, from Neutrogena to Farsali and the names didn't stop here. This shows that the market that Botanic Boutique operates in is a heavily saturated market with very well-established old brands. These brands have a wide product range, have higher reach and marketing budgets, have a wide customer base which is extremely loyal to them, have well developed marketing techniques over the years and extensive data on consumer insights over the year which they can make use of and rely immensely on, have customer satisfaction programs and retention techniques which start-up brands like Botanic Boutique cannot acquire or establish given the scale of the business, reach of it and the budget constraints that exist. Botanic Boutique however, has a unique selling point as compared to many established brands out there which is that its products are completely organic. The established brands have been in the market for a very long time and were far away from being organic, now that the damage of certain chemicals is more known to people they have started shifting to natural, organic products but this will take a time for them to establish themselves differently from that. Moreover, Botanic Boutique operates on Instagram which targets the younger population more who are likely to become the future adults with the buying power mainly. If Botanic Boutique capitalizes on this situation and is able to establish itself as a reliable and effective brand in skin and hair care for these young people, then the growth for it will be inevitable. The market is already a growing one. The competitors that are Instagram based and have similar product ranges like elixirs, essential oils to pose a threat and a competitive environment for Botanic Boutique like Hira Ali Beauty, Spa in a Bottle, co-natural Bk hair oil and so on, the solution to this is customer acquisition and retention.

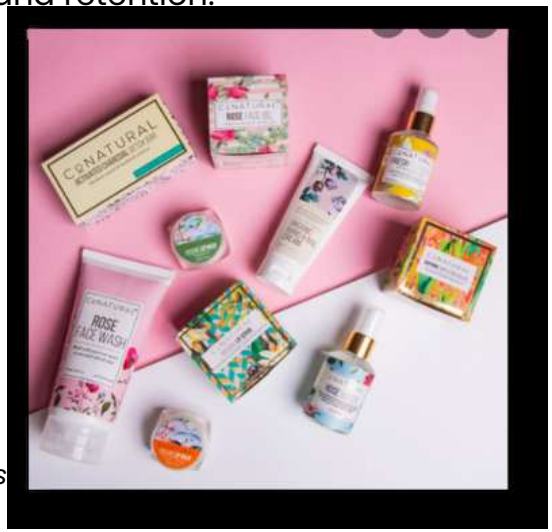



*Fig: CoNatural Products*

# OBSERVATION INSIGHTS

Our first observation technique was ‘experimentation’, where a group of participants was introduced to the social media pages of Botanic Boutique. Each participant was permitted to browse through the page and comment on how they felt about it. As a result of the positive feedback, we were able to retrieve a lot of insights. The appealing color palette and minimalistic theme attracted all the participants. They were quite happy with the phenomenal photography and natural greenery theme in their posts. In addition to this, our team was noticing difference in their body language and gestures. Participants appeared elated. We could observe the smiles on their faces while browsing. Their facial expressions showed the emotions that they had. The highly dilated eyes indicated the level of desire displayed by some of the individuals. Crinkles in the corner of their eyes indicated that they were sincerely drawn to the page's aesthetics, and their comments only confirmed this. Furthermore, the product variety was praised. They also stated that the customer experience is enhanced by the reviews and testimonials on their page since they can gauge what people are saying about the brand. It simply boosts credibility. After that, everyone was asked to choose the products they would purchase if they had to. This was done in order to determine which types of products people favor and why. We were able to observe that the options were extremely varied, demonstrating the various options available to different choices/needs people had. It's worth noting that few of the participants were also pleased with their discount plan.

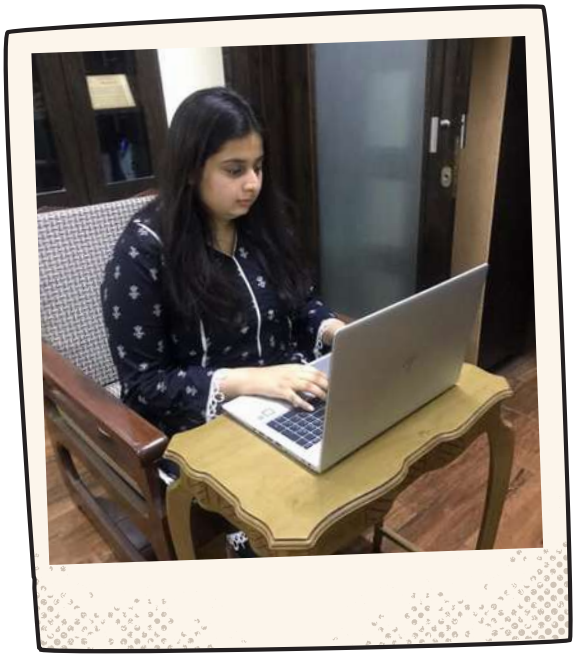
**“It's really helpful that they've put ingredients for each product.” ~ Shehreyaar**

> They’re seems to be structure and consistency. A decent amount of information is provided. The fact that they are reviews and highlights really get me excited ~ Ahmed Rao



- **NEGATIVES**

Despite the fact that the participants like the overall experience of Botanic Boutique's pages, numerous flaws were identified. Participants mentioned that they had a lot of reviews on the page that they couldn't trust because many of them could be fake. Second, posts of influencers promoting BB's products can be misleading too as they are paid and cannot be trusted. Even if they have used it and have worked well for them that doesn't mean it will work well for us too as everyone has a very different skin nature so in terms of skin care, so depending on influencers for skincare would not be a good idea.
**Ahmed Rao: "I'd rather go with a product that my family has used or that I've heard about through word of mouth. I wouldn't go with influencers since their skin is different from mine, so I'd rather go with a tried-and-tested brand recommended by someone I know because our skin types might be more comparable."**
People said that because the page didn't have as many followers (2.5k) as most of their competitors, it was difficult to rely on them. They also went on to say that the page is missing the 'Human Element.' BB have not yet included other people's experiences. Videos relating to that may have boosted the brand's credibility and image. Hira Ali Beauty, a competitor, employs this tactic to their advantage. Also, some have commented that their costs are relatively low compared to the market, so are they truly organic? This issue created a doubt in the minds of the consumer.
It was worth noting that when the participants were stating the negatives of the brand, there body language changed as for instance their facial expression and sitting postures showed that they didn't like a certain thing.





## • ALFATAH VISIT

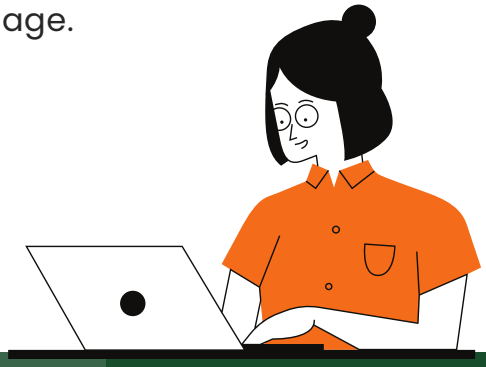



The second Method in observation was the visit to a store so that we can observe the behaviour of competitor's customers in order to gain insights into the perceptions that the consumers had about them. We decided to visit Alfatah after Iftari around 9pm and started observing people in the skin and hair care row from a distance. We witnessed people coming in and picking their products and leaving. They didn't seem to inquire much about the product. It implied that customers who came to a retail store to buy competitor products had been devoted customers for a long time and were only there to buy the products they desired. Nivea, Lorael, and Garnier were among the most popular products.

These are the brands that are well established and have a high customer base. Their customers experiment less and rely on these products. For them, buying these products is low involvement which falls under the variety seeking behavior rather than dissonance buying behavior established for BB's customers.

## • Social Listening:

We weren't able to gather substantial data to make a claim on as there weren't many comments under their posts. However, this led to us raising a concern that their social media content was less engaging and they needed to work on creating a more interactive page.



# INTERVIEW INSIGHTS

From the interviews that we conducted we got some insights on how the skin care regimes are heavily influenced by youtube and instagram videos, and this also allows people to not to stick to one product but try and use more, relatively new products. We also came to know that the buyers would mostly make a very calculated decision when it comes to skin and hair care products purchasing; they'll look at reviews, packaging, ingredients, recommendations, aesthetics, and influencers advocating it. Price is usually an important factor as high price gives better quality perception but that is not true for all the users. Moreover, influencer marketing according to people is one way to make them buy the product but not the only way and relying on it to heavily should not be done because at the end of the day these influencers are more or less getting paid for promoting the brand and skin and hari care is extremely personal. One product might work for someone but not for others so these are important decisions and considerations for the customers buying from botanic boutique or similar brands. With the help of the interviews that we conducted we were able to make a customer day map. Which gives insight on what the potential customer for botanic boutique is doing, feeling and consuming at a particular time of the day. This will help the owners to develop and execute marketing strategies and to place the product where the customer would exactly be. Moreover, we interviewed people from the 2 customer segments that the owner mentioned as their target market: students and working woman/ men who need an on the go care. The interviews of Sarah and Asma helped us develop consumer personas for these two categories. The consumer day map and consumer personas are as follows:



- **Consumer day Map:**

Through interviewing and observation we were able to come up with the following consumer day map for the customer segment that botanic boutique targets and aims to target. This consumer day map helps us determine the touch points for the customer of botanic boutique throughout the day and will help them design and execute the marketing plan according to what customer is doing, thinking, feeling and consuming at a certain time of the day.

| Consumer Day Map | What are they doing? | What are they Thinking about? | What Media are they consuming? |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Morning (8:00am-12:00pm)** | Sleep, study, breakfast, work,, drive | Schedule, Tasks, food, responsibilities, assignments, deliverables, improvements, business opportunities | Facebook, Instagram, snapchat, WhatsApp, YouTube, ms teams, radio, tv/cable |
| **Afternoon (12:00am-4:00pm)** | Lunch, work, hangout with friends, exercise | Food, work, needs/wants, catching up on different platforms, stressful situations, job applications, regular life decisions, how to complete tasks | Facebook, Instagram, snapchat, WhatsApp, YouTube, ms teams, radio, tv/cable, game applications, email, health apps |
| **Evening (4:00pm-8:00pm)** | Exercise, snack time, movies/shows, family time, socialize, work, household stuff, shop, outdoor activities, drive, sports | Friends, family, workout, media, trends, events | Facebook, Instagram, snapchat, WhatsApp, YouTube, ms teams, radio, tv/cable, game applications, email, health apps, netflix, amazon prime, tiktok |
| **Night (8:00pm-12:00am)** | Dinner, drive, family time, socialise, movie/show,sports, sleep | Pending activities, planning next day, the whole day, food to eat, place to visit, recreational activity | Facebook, Instagram, snapchat, WhatsApp, YouTube, ms teams, radio, tv/cable, game applications, email, health apps, netflix, amazon prime, tiktok |

## CONSUMER PERSONA 1: Student

Sarah is a 23-year-old university student. She is a hostelite based in Lahore but she lives far away from LUMS so she chose to take a room in a hostel. She is the only girl in her family and has an active lifestyle but when it comes to cooking or self-pampering, she does not have a lot of energy for that. Her skin is a combination skin and her hair have a rough texture. In order to keep her skin fresh and healthy she needs to apply some elixirs which would suit her skin, once she likes a product, she is likely to use it always and looks for less effort more result-based products. For hair care, she prefers essential oils because she has noticed if she applies serums and chemical-based products to her hair, it is harder for her to tame it. Though her food routine is not particularly healthy but she makes sure to eat fruits at least once a day mostly in morning. She has a big social circle and most of her buying decisions are influenced by her friends and peers. Her personal budget is 30,000 rupees per month with a monthly household income of 300,000 rupees.

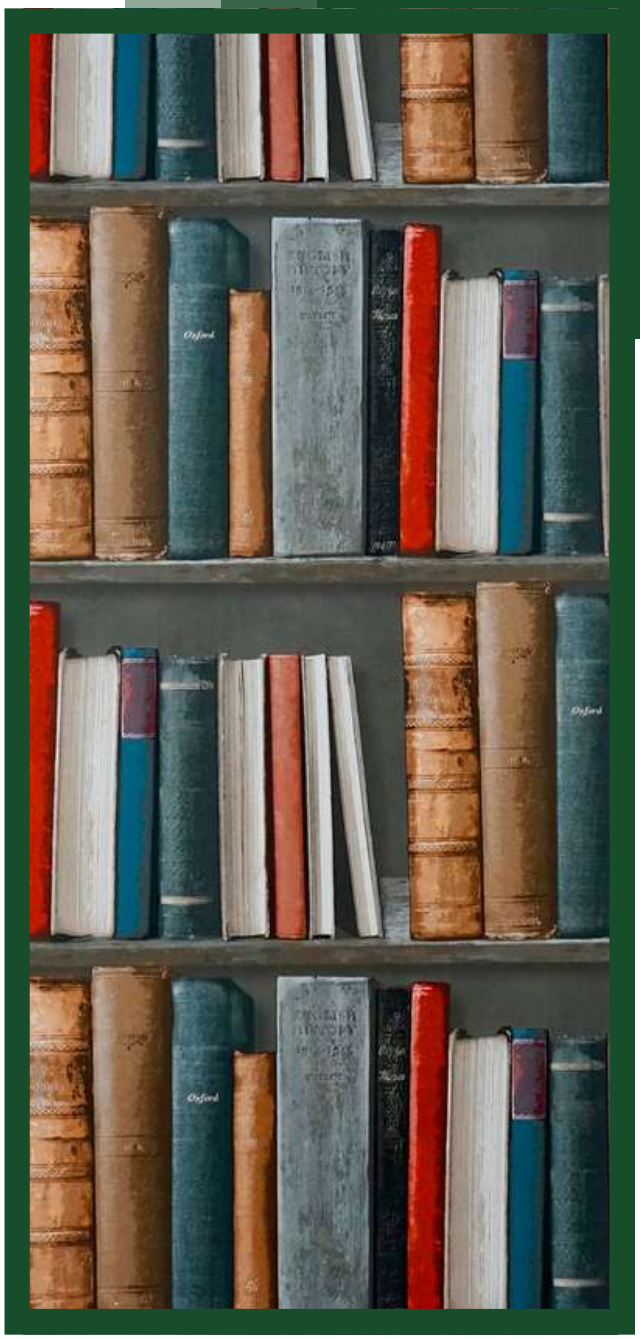
## CONSUMER PERSONA 2: A Working Woman

Asma is a 38-year-old working woman. She works for Beaconhouse in their administration department. She is a full-time mom to 3 children. Finding work life balance is extremely important for her. She likes to pamper herself but does not have time to go to salons or use homemade remedies. She wants spa in a bottle and that is the reason why she purchases from spa in a bottle. She is price sensitive when it comes to skin or hair care as she prioritizes her children's expenses over her personal. Her life revolves around her family and extended family. She meets her sisters on weekends. Besides this she likes to keep herself updated on social media trends and is an active user of WhatsApp and Instagram. She prefers to buy skin and hair care products from a store over online but if she has already tested a product once then she is comfortable with ordering it online through an official website again.

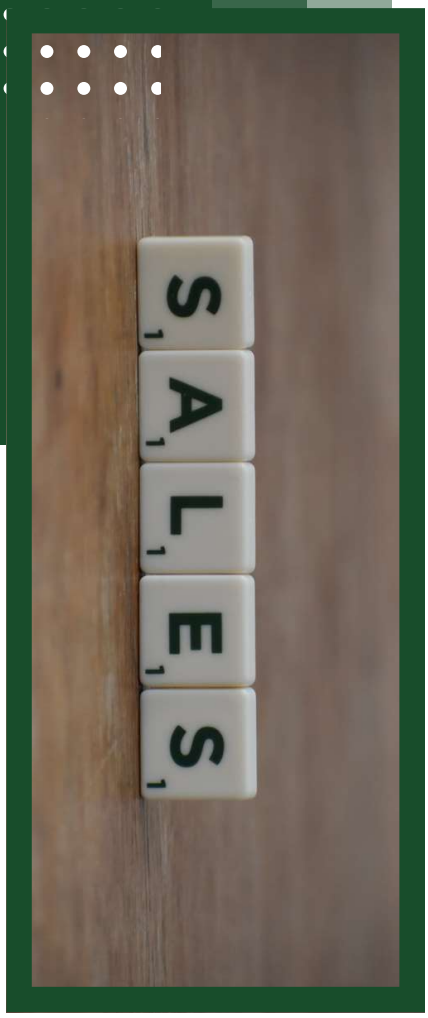


# SECONDARY RESEARCH INSIGHTS

- **Literature Review:**



First of all, we analysed that how the already existing brands increased their consumer base by using social media. There are different tactics that brands used. First of all, they prioritize excellent customer service both pre and post purchase. No matter if one is asking you a lot of questions or the same thing 10 times, you have to explain everything to them with patience. You need to treat them as if your entire world revolves around them. As it is a common saying, “Customer is the King”. It will help you to build your brand identity and ultimately increase sales because word of mouth is a major factor in acquiring new customers (“10 Secret Ways to Increase the Customer Base for Your E-Commerce Store”). Moreover, as we learnt, we need to make our customers into clients. Only that way, we can cater to each customer personally. Secondly, by high social media engagement, you can not only gain new customers, but it can also help you to create a strong brand identity of your brand (7 Proven Ways to Build Your Ecommerce Customer Base). The more you stay online, post quality content and use the right strategies like hashtags, taglines and captions etc. to stand out, the more people see you. Lastly, you need to focus on user generated content. It really helps in customer decision journey (Vázquez, Silvia). It carries more reliability since it is coming from someone who has already tried the brand. Therefore, you should incentivize your customers to post about you with the relevant taglines and hashtags so that it gets the proper reach.




As a part of our secondary research, as also discussed earlier, we analyzed Botanic Boutique's competitors and their social media pages as well. For example, Hira Ali Beauty is a skin and hair care brand which is a competitor of Botanic Boutique. On their Instagram page, they share the review videos that are made by their customers a lot. Secondly, they share the posts in which the commonly faced skin and hair problems are discussed. This really helps the consumers to understand about the problem that their product is solving. We think that Botanic Boutique should do it more often as well. Secondly, their competitors are regularly posting content on their pages and they keep it up to date. This shows that the brand is active. They also use influencer marketing regularly in which some famous influencers endorse their products on their profiles. These tactics help to spread the brand name to the right audience which ultimately helps in creating brand identity

- **Data of Botanic Boutique:**

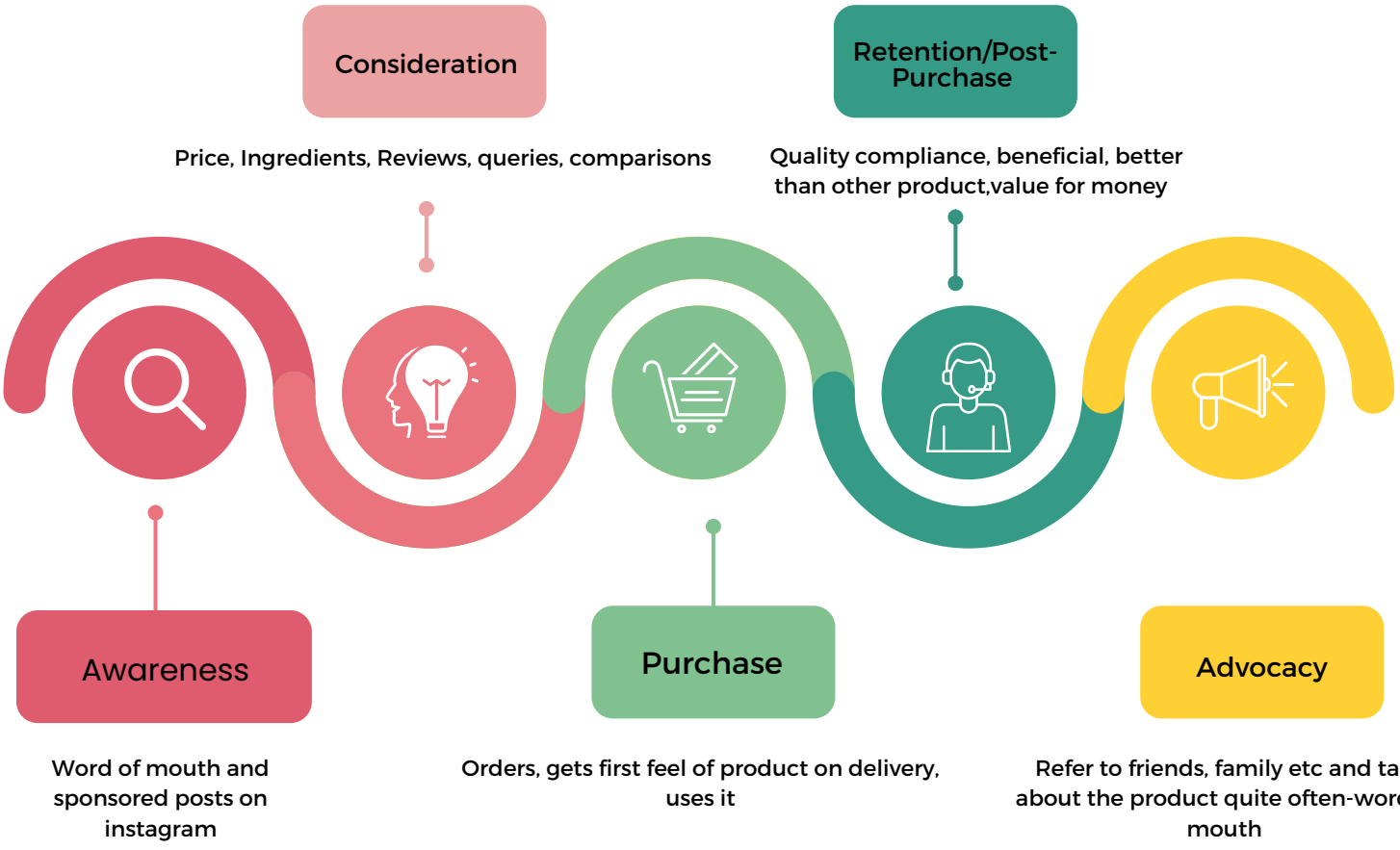
We used the financial data of Botanic Boutique to see that what are the areas that need more attention and what improvements can be made. When we see at the sales data, almost 70% of the total sales are hair oils. Out of these, Parfaire is the highest selling product. This is a combination of organic oils that help in maintaining strong hair and helps in gaining volume. Essential oils category comes at the second number with total of 22% sales. These numbers provide insight about the needs of the consumers and ultimately helps brand to focus on these products. After the sales data, the Instagram feed of their page shows that the posts with the highest engagement are the client reviews (photos or videos). This again endorses the idea of the impact that user generated content has on buying decision. This helps in gaining the credibility for the products. Lastly, Botanic Boutique's followers on Instagram are 2482. This is a very low number and they really need to launch social media campaigns to increase that number. The first thing a potential buyer notices about you is the number of followers on your page. This helps in gaining the trust of the visitor and build credibility which ultimately helps in increasing sales.

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# CUSTOMER JOURNEY

The journey of a Botanic Boutique's customer usally begins with awareness stage where they find about the brand and the products that it is offering through word of mouth or the sponsored post on instagram. They then enter the consideration stage where they visit the instagram page go through it thoroughly, seek out the products, look for it's reviews, inbox for queries, look for ingredients and compare the product price/features with that of competitor. Followed by that is the stage when the customer ends up ordering the product and once it is delivered gets the first feel of the product. Once the customer starts using the product the insights show that they are likely to make a repeat pruchase once they have used the product and seen its advantage but this stage of retention time frame spans for about 6months or more as the effectiveness of the skin and hair care products is not short-term and the product is also likely to last for 6 months. Lastly, the customer upon liking the product becomes an advocate for the product where they refer it to people around them and word of mouth plays an important role in starting another similar consumer journey. The consumer journey for each consumer spans for about a years time or more due to the nature of the product.

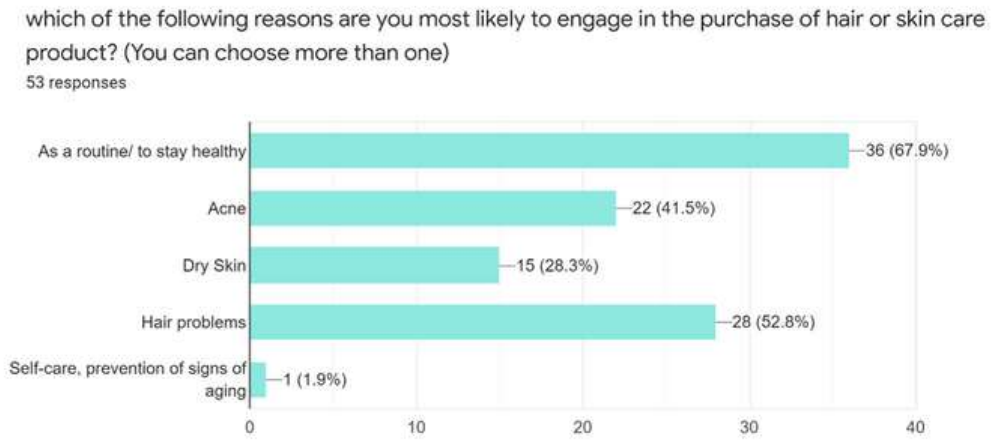


- **THROUGH SURVEY INSIGHTS**

For our primary research, we conducted focus groups and survey to analyze that how customers reach their buying decision and what are the key factors that influence them to make a purchase. Through our survey, we were able to identify the stages that a consumer goes through before making a final decision. There are five stages that a consumer goes through, i.e., Need Recognition, Information Search, Evaluation of Alternatives, Purchase decision and post purchase behavior.

## Need Recognition:

Need recognition is when someone is able to identify a gap between their current and the desired state. So, the consumers in this case, recognize the need to buy a hair or skin care product when they want to improve their hair/skin health. About 68% respondents responded that they purchase these products as a routine hair/skin care health. About 41.5% respondents purchase it because of acne issues on their face. 52.8% people have hair problems which influence them to purchase a hair care product. These statistics give us insight that how we can use our marketing campaigns to acquire new customer by focusing on the major issues that trigger the need of purchasing hair/skincare product.

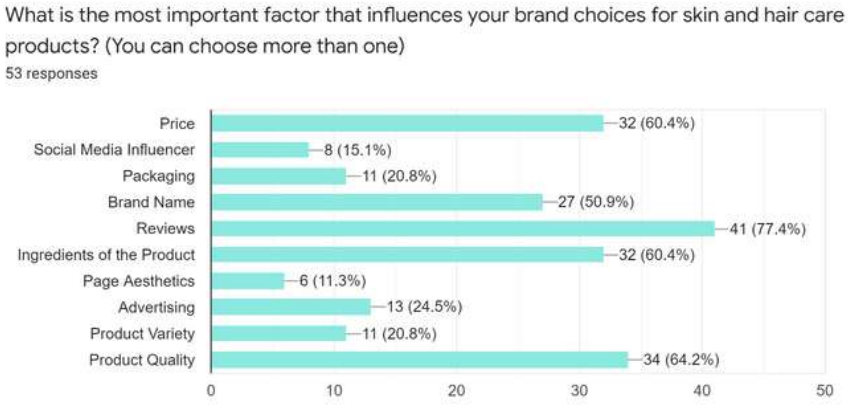



## Information search:

After the need recognition, the second stage is the information search where the consumers search for different alternatives available in the market. Our survey results show that respondents go through various pages and reviews before buying for a product. They do not purchase until they are fully satisfied. This shows that this product segment falls in the high involvement category of the products. During this time, customers search for different brands and develop a brand image in their minds through the social media pages, number of followers on your page, reviews and the level of engagement.

## Evaluation of Alternatives:

After searching the information about different brands, consumers then evaluate these alternatives on different factors. The factors and their importance are shown in the image attached below. This shows that reviews have the highest impact on choosing a certain brand over other (77.4%). After these, quality, ingredients and brand name/number of followers are amongst the major factors that affect the decision of choosing a brand and product.

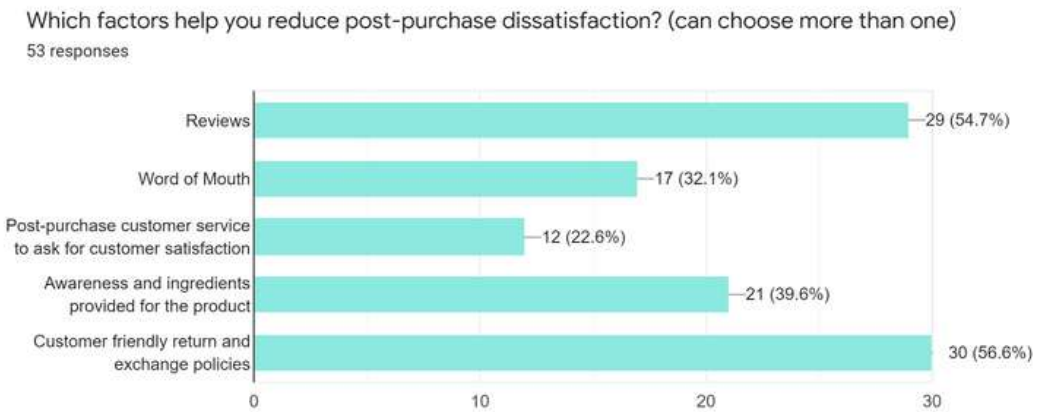



## Purchase decision:

At this stage, the consumers have already compared different options in the market and have ranked botanic boutique over other options. About 79.2% respondents said that they make the final decision of buying the product. However, he can still drop the final decision of buying the item because of factors like purchase mode (online/instore), mode of payments, delivery costs or social influence.

## Post Purchase Behavior:

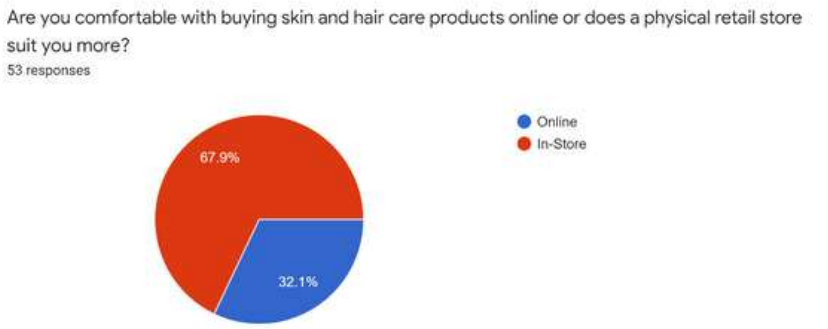
After making the purchase, the post purchase behavior of consumer will decide that whether he will come back to the brand or not. The data gathered through survey shows that the customer friendly return and exchange policies play the most important role in it along with the reviews about the product/brand. Awareness about the ingredients of product also play vital role in post purchase satisfaction. Therefore, steps can be taken to cater to these needs as well.



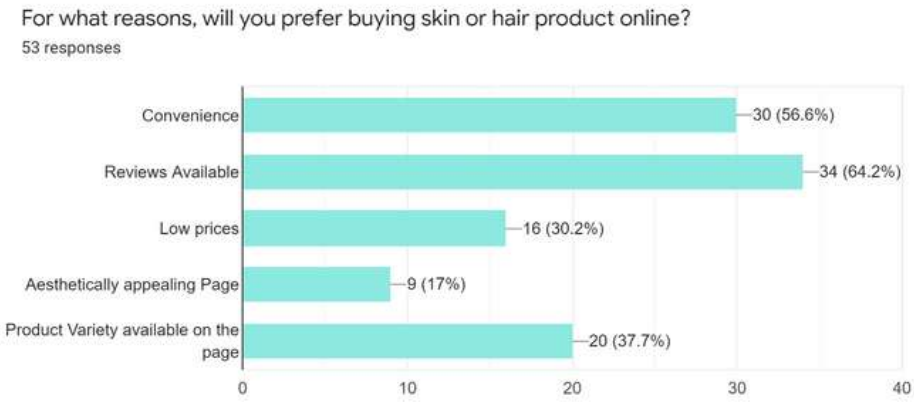
## OTHER SURVEY INSIGHTS

- **Online vs In-store:**

Currently, the Botanic Boutique is only selling online through its Instagram page. They do not have any availability in retail stores etc. The survey we conducted showed that majority (67.9%) of respondents prefer to buy these products in stores rather than online.

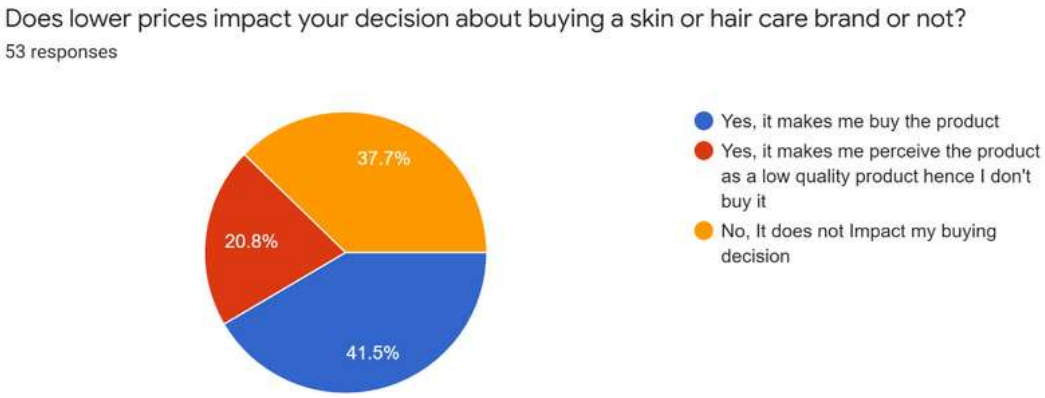



However, consumers can still be influenced to purchase online by using different means. For example, 64.2% people can purchase online if the reviews are available. Second important factor is convenience. This shows that if a brand is only selling online, it should be as convenient as possible to cater to in store shopping preference. For example, the delivery should be convenient, different mode of payments should be accepted. The delivery partner should be a renowned company which covers the most of the geographic regions.



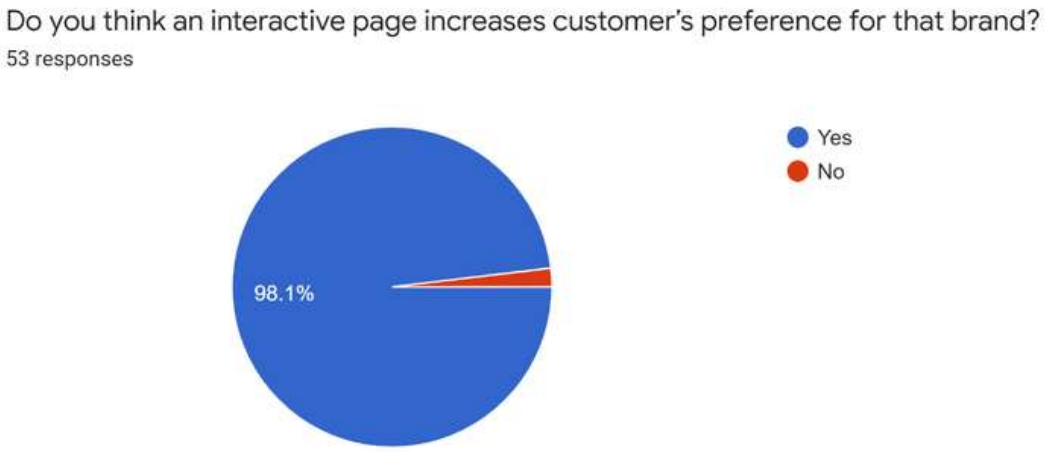

## Price and Perception:

One major problem faced by the founders was that whether the low prices make the perception of low quality in the mind of consumers. so, we wanted to address that in our research as well. The survey results clearly show that this thinking exists, however, it is very less in number. Only 20.8% respondents think that the low price is perceived as low quality and eventually they do not purchase such item. 41.5% respondents clearly said that they would purchase the product if the price is lower




## Interactive Page:

The vast majority of the respondents (98.1%) said that the interactive page increases their preference towards a certain brand. This shows the importance of managing the social media pages and regularly posting content to it. This is linked with other important factors as well like the credibility of the brand.



# CONSUMER BUYING BEHAVIOR




## HIGH CUSTOMER INVOLVEMENT

Before purchasing a certain skin and hair care product, most new customers go through various pages, and reviews before finalizing their decision. This is because skin and hair care products are risky by nature. You are using these products on your face and skin, therefore would not want to experiment with new untested products. As Asad said in the focus group, "I usually go to my trusted and tried brands", even our survey results strengthened this as almost 50% of respondents searched for more than one hour before actually purchasing the product, hence we can conclude that skin and hair care products have high involvement as people carry our research before buying them.

## FEW DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE BRANDS

In the skin and hair care industry, product differentiation is very difficult. There are various competitors such as Hira Ali Beauty for skin and CoNaturals for hair which sell the exact same products. For example, you have hair growth oils present in both brands, hence we can say that skin and hair care are not very diverse field. Due to this reason, we can say that there are few differences between brands.

## LOW BRAND SWITCHING

A consumer behavior insight we gauged from our focus group was that usually if customers are satisfied with a certain skin and hair product, they would not change it. This links to the idea that skin and hair care are risky, and we do not tend to experiment with them. In other words, trying and testing a new product is risky. Majority of our focus group participants agreed that they do not change their skin and hair product brand if they are comfortable with it and it suits them, thus skin and hair products have low brand switching.

## INFREQUENT PURCHASE

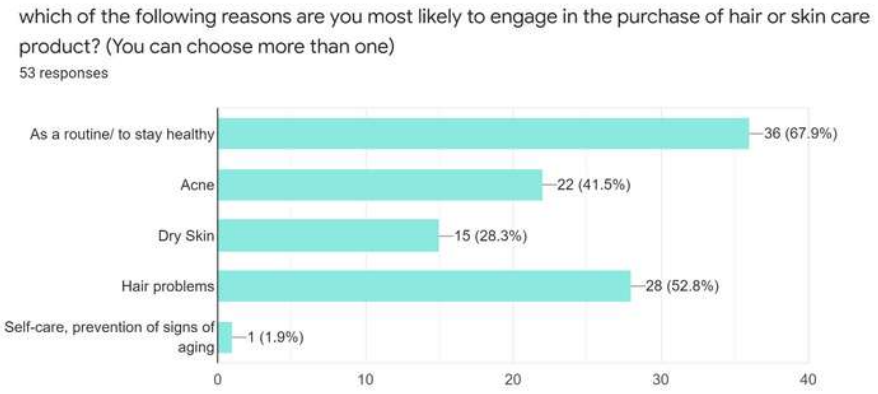
Skin and hair care products aren't something you buy often, they are bought after careful evaluation and consulting friends and family. Thus, these goods are bought infrequently after 4-5 months once the product is finished, hence we can categorize them as infrequent purchases.

# BUYING ROLES

They are the steps performed by a set of people while making a purchasing decision. It is critical for marketers to understand who performs what role in order to build products and adverts accordingly. It is also significant for BB to determine which individuals and events play a significant influence in the customer's decision.

## Initiator:

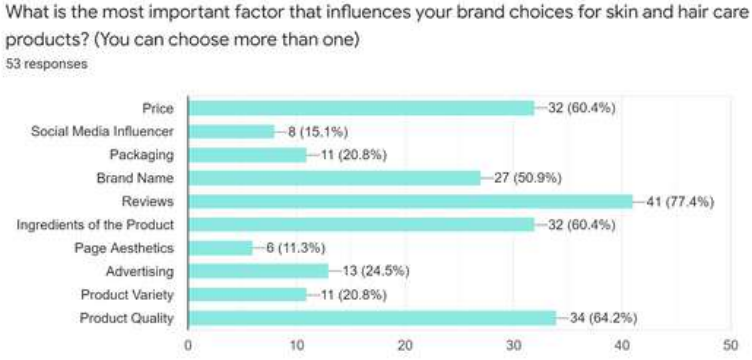
It's an event or person that indicates the need to purchase a specific item. The reasons why a customer purchases a skin or hair care product are shown in the following survey results.




The majority of respondents in our focus groups and survey (67.9%) said they use such skin or hair products as part of their daily routine to stay healthy. Hair issues were also a major influence. People now utilise a variety of hair products that are tailored to their hair structure and assist them in resolving their issues.

## Influencer

Again, an influencer is an event or person who has an impact on a person's decision to purchase a product or service.



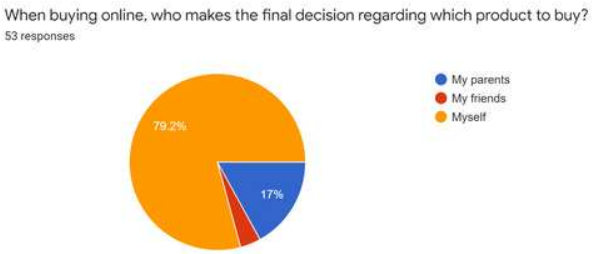
Our focus group and interview findings highlighted that most of people are significantly influenced by the quality and listing of ingredients on the page when it comes to buying a skin care or hair care product online. On the other hand, few also mentioned that recommendations from friends and family was an important determining factor because they were able to trust them and their skin nature might be similar to their closure ones. During the Covid-19 Scenario, reviews and testimonials from other customers played the biggest role than any other factor in the purchase decision. The results of the survey reiterated what we found from our focus groups: social media influencers were viewed as less important. Other important aspects that consumers consider when making a decision include ingredient listing (60.4 percent), product quality (64.2 percent), and reviews/testimonials (77.4 percent).

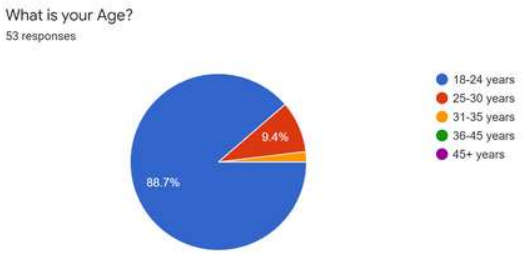
## Decider:

The decider will be the one who, in the end, determines any part of the overall buying decision, including to buy what, how, and where. For BB, deciders are generally our end users, and according to our poll too, they are men and women between the ages of 18 and 25, who are either university students or professionals.

## Buyer:

The buyers are the one who are responsible for purchasing and paying for the item which in our scenario as per the survey, 79.2 % were the users themselves.




## User:

Finally, the end users are the individuals who consume the product or service and according to our survey are middle- and upper-class university students and fresh graduate employees within age 18 and 25 in most cases. As we had some sample limitations, we weren't able to find insights into how millennials and baby boomers would react.

# RECOMMENDATIONS
## Short-Term



- **Improving their engagement and content marketing on social media/Brand Awareness:**

Botanic Boutique is an online brand and that's the most important point of contact with its customers is social media platforms that's why they should put extra effort into engaging their customers through different activities like giveaways, interacting with the customers through comments, and arranging different QnA sessions to address the concerns of their customers. Moreover, they can arrange different Instagram Lives and contests with gift hampers for the winners. This will help in building trust between customers and the owners, and the customers will feel connected to the brand. This will eventually enlarge their customer base and the number of loyal customers as well. Moreover, instead of only advertising their products on their social media pages they should post content about how hair and skincare are necessary, their benefits, and how important it is for our self-care. This way, they can attract customers at the information search stage.

- **Creating a website:**

Since Botanic Boutique is an online brand, it should create its website because while ordering the products from online pages, there remains some doubt in the minds of the customer which must be taken care of. So, BB should create its website, and the customers should be able to place their orders from there. Moreover, there should be a proper system of tracking the order once it is placed so that customers would know when they are going to receive their product and it will make their customer experience better.

- **Promoting on YouTube**

As the interviews suggested that the hair and skin care regimes are influenced heavily by YouTube, it is essentially important for Botanic Boutique to place their product on YouTube as well and use it as a platform to spread awareness about their product. They can do it through sponsored ads, YouTube influencers or their direct YouTube channel (which can be the last option).

# RECOMMENDATIONS
## Short-Term



- **Work on making the customer experience better**

The botanic boutique should work on making the overall customer experience better because this is the most important aspect when it comes to making your business a success. They should provide the real-time location tracking option for their customers because it will give them relief knowing when they are going to receive their product. Moreover, they should keep in contact with their customers by sending them emails and SMS if any new product is added to the product range or any previously finished product gets replenished, it will help in making the customer experience better because they would that this brand cares about them and their needs. Moreover, to assist the customers in choosing which product they should buy, they should display their best-selling products on their social media pages and website as well.

- **Catering to customer complaints effectively**

Botanic Boutique is a brand that is operating through Instagram and if a customer complains about something then they have to directly message them, sometimes their genuine concerns and complaints remain unheard because of this lousy procedure. They should create a complaint portal on their website, where their concerns would not go unnoticed and immediate action would be taken to fix the problems being faced by the customers or they can have a live chat feature on their website. It will not only build the confidence and trust of existing customers, but it will also help gain more customers as well. They should take a proactive approach and try resolving the problems before they happen. And for this, they should regularly call their customers and ask them about how their experience is and how satisfied they are with the product the whole procedure should also take feedback on how they can improve and should also incorporate the suggestions from customers. They need to make the assistance of video calling available where representatives can easily address to customers' problems or any inquiries. This all can be done when the website is created. This is the Post-Purchase stage where providing customer friendly exchange and return policies (as survey suggested) would increase customer satisfaction and customer lifetime value.

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# RECOMMENDATIONS
## Short-Term

- **Focusing on Reviews and Human Element**

As discussed in the focus group insights and the survey as well, having reviews is the biggest factor that contributes to winning the consumer trust and securing a credible positioning in consumer minds. Another recommendation associated with it is having more human touch on the Instagram page. This was discussed in the focus group as well where many participants mentioned it. Therefore, if Botanic Boutique is able to get more customer reviews, especially in the form of pictures or videos, it will definitely increase their sales and leave happy and satisfied customers. They can do that by incentivizing their customers to leave reviews by giving them some discount coupons or loyalty points for their future purchases.



# RECOMMENDATIONS
## Long-Term

- **Expanding the Men's Product Line:**

Botanic Boutique has the advantage that they have skin and hair care products for men, they should take this opportunity and expand the range of products for men because currently there are very less brands that are making such products for men like Daari mooch, etc. Botanic Boutique can fill this market gap and work on this to its advantage.

- **Expand into the Retail sector:**

No doubt that online shopping is convenient and it is believed to have very promising future prospects, one cannot simply ignore the experience that a consumer gets in an in-store purchase. This can be seen from the survey result as well that the 67.9% of consumers prefer to purchase these products in stores. This behavior was seen in focus groups as well where respondents mentioned that in an in-store setting, they can compare different options on the spot, compare their quality and packaging and make a purchase decision right there. Therefore, Botanic Boutique should try to get their products stocked in the major shopping malls like Alfatah, Carrefour, Imtiaz mall etc. In start, they can focus on the big cities like Lahore, Karachi, and Islamabad and later on expand into more cities.
However, there will be additional costs and some pre-requisites in order to be able to sell in these superstores. First of all, you need to register your brand name. This process is relatively less costly around Rs. 5000/- to 10000/-, however, the trademark registration itself is a very time-consuming task and it may take from 12 to 18 months (Kickstart). Other than that, the costs to get a shelve in superstore like Al Fateh is around Rs. 50,000 with commissions on each sale. These steps will push the owners to increase the prices of their products in order to cover the additional costs.



# RECOMMENDATIONS
## Long-Term

- **Collaboration with Salons / Institutional Selling:**

One of the biggest sales points for such grooming products is the hair & beauty salons. The sales from such collaborations are big in volume because hundreds of customers walk into these salons daily to groom themselves. The barbers have an influence in these because they can convince you to purchase a product right there and then. They also use such products in salons while treating their customers. For example, the essential oils can be used during face massages, hair oils can be used while treating hair. One other advantage will be that the selling costs will be lower because the brand doesn't have to spend on marketing in that case. Barber/Salon will be doing that for you. The only costs will be the commission that the salon will be keeping which is mutually decided by negotiations in such cases.

- **Campus Ambassador Program**

We recommend botanic boutique to recruit ambassadors from various schools and universities. These individuals will help promote the product in the institution and in return will get free products. The target population of Botanic Boutique is currently college/university students who usually don't have time for skin and hair care. This approach will be effective as it targets our target population of busy gen z consumers. It will also raise brand awareness for them and their name will be known to target population which is the first step in marketing and consumer journey of customers.



# APPENDIX

- **FOCUS GROUP STRUCTURE**

**Focus Group 1 & 2**
**Date/Day**: Sunday, 10th April 2022
**Time:** 8:00 pm and 9:00 pm
**Mode:** Zoom (audio/video recorded)
**Duration**: 45 Min - 1 hour
**Participants (potential customers/non-users):**

- Maryam Imran 22
- Saira Saeed 21
- Fatima Umar 28
- Noor Adnan 24
- Junaid Ahmed 30
- Mian Hassan 22
- Aimen Farrukh 22

**Participants (Users):**

- Masooma 19
- Asad Jawa 21
- Shahbano 22
- Muhammad Ahmad 22
- Wajahat khawaja 24
- Muhammad Hassan 23
- Ahmed Rao 21
- Areeba Usman 26
- Alizeh Sultan 20

**Role Division:**

- **Moderator:** Imman Ali Malik, Malyka Suhail
- **Note Takers:** Muhammad Zair Ali, Muhammad Haseeb
- **Recorder and Screensharer:** Hira Hussain

**Introduction and Disclaimers:**

Hello everyone, I hope you all are doing well. We welcome you all to the focus group session for today. My name is Imman Ali Malik, and I will be the moderator of this focus group along with Malyka Suhail.
Our research study focuses on the consumption habits of consumers concerning skin care and hair care products. Our primary focus is to obtain insights into consumers' perception of skin and hair care.

We want to thank you all for your willingness to participate in this focus group. As part of our Consumer Behaviour project, we aim to gather insights from this focus group on customers' experience with the purchase of skin and hair care products. We encourage you to share your honest opinions with us so that we can gather actionable data that enables us to look into the customer mindset in order to allow us to gain comprehensive findings for our research.
Before we officially initiate with our focus group, I would like to share some guidelines with you all, after which we can begin by starting with a brief introduction from all of you.
1. We encourage you all to speak up and would like your maximum participation. I may call you if I haven't heard from you for a while.
2. We would like to emphasize that there are no right or wrong answers as each individual's experiences and opinions matter. We do not anticipate consensus; we hope to have a wide variety of opinion
3. We aim to have this room be a safe space, so please ensure not to belittle anyone's experience and ensure that only one speaker is talking at a time.
4. The discussion will last for approximately 40 mins.
5. This session will be recorded as we want to analyze each of your opinions and gain insight from it.
6. Before we start the focus group, we would like each one of you to give your consent verbally. We have also shared a form for digital confirmation of consent for official purposes, so in case you have not received it please alert one of the moderators.

## Questions:

### Ice Breaking Questions:

1. Please introduce yourself in one line
2.What's the first thing that comes into your mind when we say skin care?
3.What's the first thing that comes into your mind when we say hair care?
4. Name those skin care brands that you've heard of?
5. Name those hair care brands that you've heard of?
6. Do you follow a proper skin and hair care routine? For f2(this includes moisturisers, sarson ka or any other oil)
7. Talk about the skin and hair care products that you've used or are using and explain the reason behind selecting that product? (only f1)

**Contextual Questions**

1. How important is skin and hair care to you?
2. How often do you use skin care products?
3. How often do you use hair care products?
4. What brands of skin/hair care products have you tried?
5.What factors would influence the brand of skin and hair care products you will purchase and which is the most important factor?
6.Does word of mouth, such as information provided by friends and family impact your decision to purchase skin/hair products from a certain brand?
7. Do you think skin and hair care companies in Pakistan have products that fulfill every demand out there? (only f1)
8.Are you comfortable with buying skin and hair care products online or does a physical retail store suit you more? Please give reasons for your answer
9)if a social media influencer is promoting a certain skin and hair care brand, would you be more inclined towards buying it, or are you indifferent?

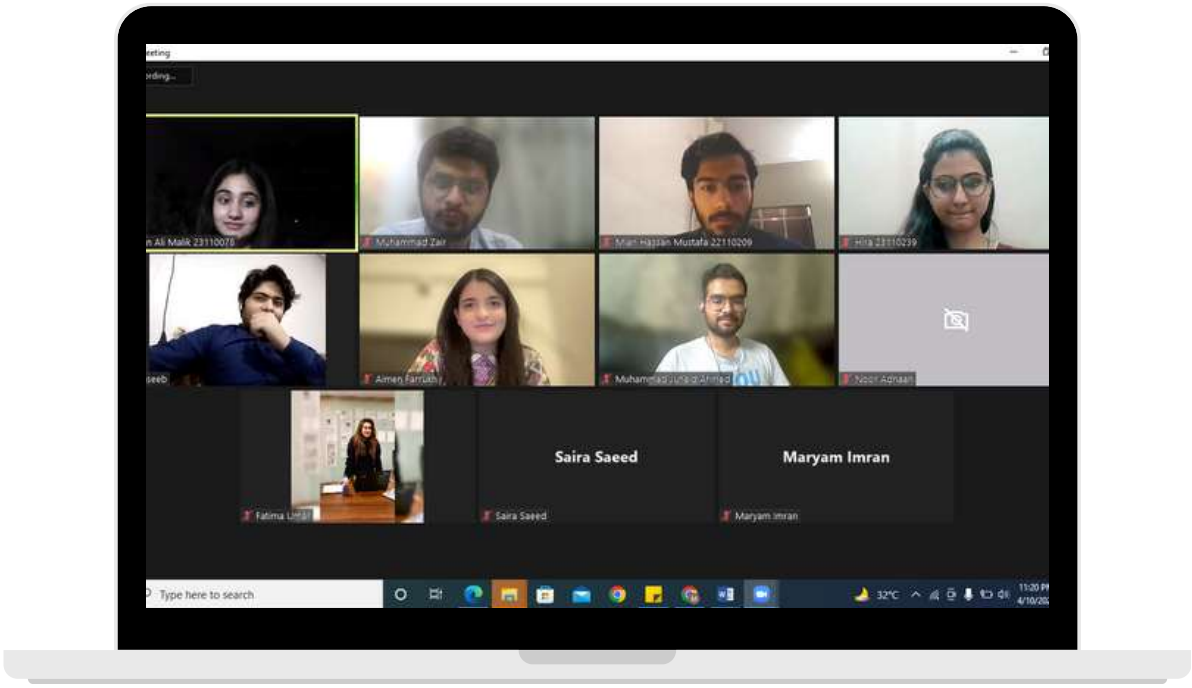
**Specific Questions:**

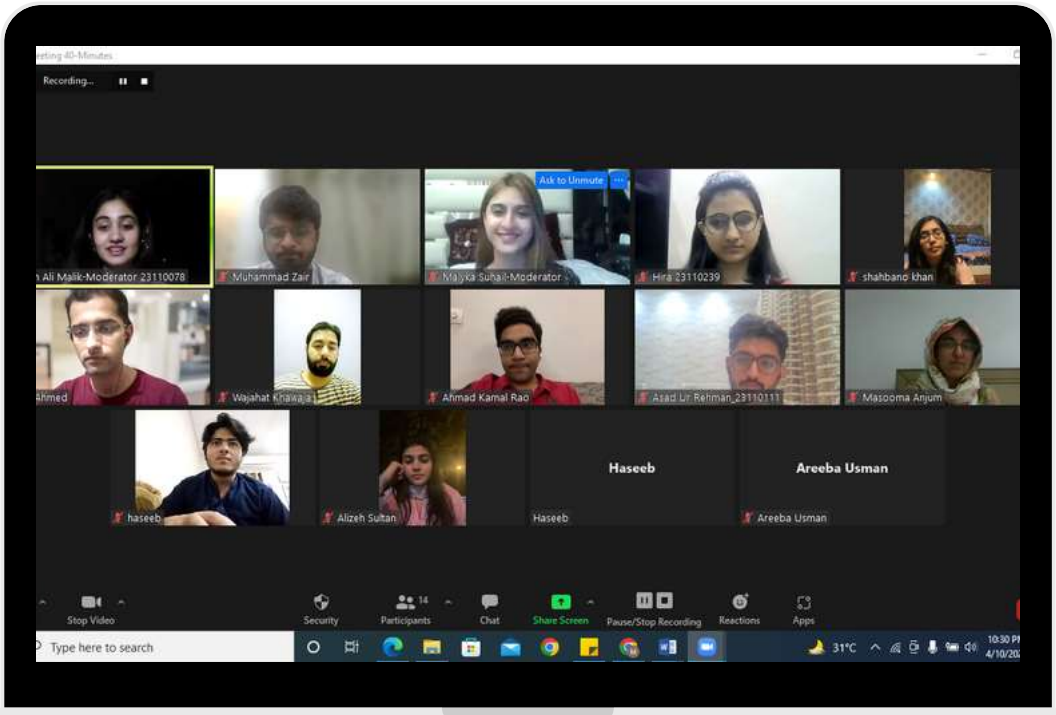
1) How familiar are you with Botanic Boutique in terms of the product, its price, and its promotion?
2)Now we will show you Botanic Boutique's social media pages, please observe? What do you find interesting about their page show bb page
3) What do you think is Botanic Boutique's USP?
4)Show them competitors' social media platforms, what differences do you see, which is better? Show Hira Ali page
5)Show them a picture of a product of BB, what do you think should be the price of these products? Bb products
6)show them a picture of competitors' products, what are your thoughts on this? What do you think is the price point? Competitors products
7)Tell them the price point of both, do you think cheaper prices impact your decision of buying a skin and hair care product?
8)can lower prices impact consumer perceptions about the image of the brand?
9) What do you think about the packaging of Botanic Boutique? (show pic)
10) Based on their advertising and packaging, how do you think BB can improve?

**Note:**

- Consent had been taken from all participants through a form.
- Further follow-up questions (not mentioned here) were asked during the conversation that helped us gather more deeper insights

- **FOCUS GROUPS**



# Skin and Hair Care Survey

Our research study focuses on the consumption habits of consumers concerning skin care and hair care products. Our primary focus is to obtain insights into consumers' perception of skin and hair care.

We want to thank you all for your willingness to fill the survey. We encourage you to share your honest opinions with us so that we can gather actionable data that enables us to look into the customer mindset in order to allow us to gain comprehensive findings for our research.

* Required

## Skin and Hair Care

1. What is your Age? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ 18-24 years
- ◯ 25-30 years
- ◯ 31-35 years
- ◯ 36-45 years
- ◯ 45+ years

2. What is your gender? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Male
- ◯ Female
- ◯ Other

3. which of the following reasons are you most likely to engage in the purchase of hair or skin care product? (You can choose more than one) *

*Check all that apply.*

- [ ] As a routine/ to stay healthy
- [ ] Acne
- [ ] Dry Skin
- [ ] Hair problems
- [ ] Other: _____

4. How long do you search for information before buying any hair or skin care product? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Less than 1 Hour
- ◯ 1-2 Hours
- ◯ 1 Day
- ◯ 1-3 Days
- ◯ 3+ Days

5. What is the most important factor that influences your brand choices for skin and hair care products? (You can choose more than one) *

*Check all that apply.*

- [ ] Price
- [ ] Social Media Influencer
- [ ] Packaging
- [ ] Brand Name
- [ ] Reviews
- [ ] Ingredients of the Product
- [ ] Page Aesthetics
- [ ] Advertising
- [ ] Product Variety
- [ ] Product Quality

6. Do you follow a proper skin and hair care routine? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No
- ◯ Partially

7. Are you comfortable with buying skin and hair care products online or does a physical retail store suit you more? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Online
- ◯ In-Store

8. When buying online, who makes the final decision regarding which product to buy? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ My parents
- ◯ My friends
- ◯ Myself

9. Does lower prices impact your decision about buying a skin or hair care brand or not? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Yes, it makes me buy the product
- ◯ Yes, it makes me perceive the product as a low quality product hence I don't buy it
- ◯ No, It does not Impact my buying decision

10. Have you ever bought anything unplanned due to social media influence? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

11. Do you think advertisements, reviews online have higher credibility in influencing purchases, than traditional marketing means? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

12. For what reasons, will you prefer buying skin or hair product online? *

*Check all that apply.*

- ☐ Convenience
- ☐ Reviews Available
- ☐ Low prices
- ☐ Aesthetically appealing Page
- ☐ Product Variety available on the page

13. Which factors help you reduce post-purchase dissatisfaction? (can choose more than one) *

*Check all that apply.*

- ☐ Reviews
- ☐ Word of Mouth
- ☐ Post-purchase customer service to ask for customer satisfaction
- ☐ Awareness and ingredients provided for the product
- ☐ Customer friendly return and exchange policies

14. Do you think an interactive page increases customer's preference for that brand? *

*Mark only one oval.*

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

15. https://www.instagram.com/_botanicboutique/?hl=en Please view this Instagram page and give a recommendation on what will increase the page engagement?

_____

16. https://www.instagram.com/hiraalibeauty/?hl=en Now look at this Instagram page and tell us which one do you like better and why?

_____

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# About
# PAQUET

This space is where you can expound on why this was created - by whom and for what purpose.  You can include details like the knowledge gaps it aims to address, the module it's part of, or the educators and publishers behind its creation. It can be formal or conversational - it's up to you!

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